

Ballarat Infrastructure & Growth Alignment Framework (IGAF)

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Acknowledgement of Traditional Custodians

The Victorian Government proudly acknowledges Victoria's Aboriginal communities and their rich culture and pays its respects to their Elders past and present. We also recognise the intrinsic connection of Traditional Owners to Country and acknowledge their contribution in the management of the land, water and resources.

We acknowledge the Wadawurrung People as Ballarat's First People and as the Traditional Owners and custodians of the land and water on which we rely. We recognise and value the ongoing contribution of the Wadawurrung community to Victorian life and how this enriches us. We embrace the spirit of reconciliation, self determination and ensuring an equal voice.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Department of Transport and Planning (DTP) through the Victorian Planning Authority (VPA) has prepared the Ballarat Infrastructure and Growth Alignment Framework (IGAF) in consultation with the City of Ballarat and at the direction of the Minister for Planning.

The IGAF provides high level strategic advice on the orderly staging and sequencing of residential growth areas to leverage off existing and committed infrastructure capacity in Ballarat.

Plan for Victoria and a shift to a compact Ballarat

Ballarat is Victoria's third largest regional city (behind Geelong and Bendigo) with a population of 121,050 people in 2024¹.

Plan for Victoria (PfV) identifies Ballarat, Geelong and Bendigo as Victoria's three Major Regional Centres. This is a designation given to locations home to more than 120,000 people, and with sufficient public transport, facilities and services for a large numbers of new homes.

Plan for Victoria sets a housing target of 46,900 net new dwellings in the City of Ballarat to 2051. Of this, 28,000 dwellings (60 percent) should be built in established areas of Ballarat, and 18,900 dwellings (40 percent) should be built in greenfield areas.

This will require **an average of 1,675 additional dwellings to be built each year to 2051**. This is a substantial increase of approximately 540 more dwellings per annum in the municipality than the ABS estimated total dwelling stock increase of an average 1,135 dwellings per annum between June 2016 and June 2022.²

Currently around 70 percent of new homes built in Ballarat are constructed in greenfield areas, that is, previously undeveloped land covered by a precinct structure plan (Ballarat West and Alfredton).³

The City of Ballarat's *Today, Tomorrow, Together – Ballarat Strategy 2015* recognised the importance of providing a diverse range of housing choices located close to existing infrastructure and services. The *Ballarat Housing Strategy 2041* embeds council's policy aspiration to accommodate half its growth in established urban areas.

Plan for Victoria's 60/40 target for growth is more ambitious again and will require a significant shift to delivering more dwellings in established areas of Ballarat. This will ensure the future urban growth of Ballarat capitalises on existing infrastructure capacity to reduce the impact on the State and local economy, the environment and to improve quality of life, bringing people closer to services.

The State Government's *Housing Statement: the decade ahead, 2024–2034* recognises that the solution to growth needs to be balanced. A balanced approach to growth is consistent with the

¹ ABS Estimated Resident Population, June 2024

² ABS Estimated Dwelling Stock, 2022

³ *Ballarat Housing Strategy 2041*, 2024.

State's and City of Ballarat's aspirations to optimise growth that utilises existing infrastructure and a more consolidated urban layout. As such, the Ballarat IGAF identifies and recommends a sequence of development areas to prioritise development of established areas with infrastructure capacity to realise State Government's 60/40 growth target.

The scale of growth, and the increasingly close relationship between the housing markets of Ballarat and Melbourne, creates the opportunity and imperative to act now to open up more housing choices in more locations within Ballarat. Table 1 below demonstrates the challenge presented to the City of Ballarat based on different policy targets to shift growth to these locations.

Table 1: City of Ballarat, New dwellings based on 2051 PfV targets scenario analysis

Development scenarios	Greenfield	Infill/Renewal	Total
Business-as-usual (70% greenfield/30% established)	1,172.5	502.5	1,675
City of Ballarat Housing Strategy (50% greenfield/50% established)	837.5	837.5	1,675
Plan for Victoria (40% greenfield/60% established)	670	1,005	1,675

Ballarat IGAF findings

The Ballarat IGAF found:

- Ballarat can meet the Plan for Victoria housing target of 46,900 net new dwellings to 2051 with a 60/40 growth scenario.
- The 15-year land supply metric required by State planning policy and Planning Practice Note 90 (PPN90) can be met within the short term without rezoning additional greenfield land. This is with existing supply and the Ballarat North Precinct Structure Plan (PSP) currently being prepared by the VPA. It is noted that some of the land in Ballarat West is constrained due to fragmentation of ownership and infrastructure where development will need to be facilitated by council.
- The Plan for Victoria target of 28,000 dwellings to 2051 for established areas (non-greenfield) in Ballarat can be achieved by:
 - Urban renewal precincts identified in the Ballarat Planning Scheme that can theoretically accommodate 14,000 dwellings or more.
 - Existing residential zoned land that can theoretically accommodate an additional 23,000 dwellings at a minimum through infill development.⁴
- The Plan for Victoria target of 18,900 dwellings to 2051 in Ballarat's greenfield areas can be achieved by:

⁴ Municipal Housing Capacity Assessment, Tract. April 2022

- Current supply of existing zoned greenfield land in Ballarat which provides approximately 24 years supply, including approximately 16 years of existing greenfield dwelling supply should all of Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan (PSP) and other zoned greenfield areas reach their development yield.
- An additional eight years of greenfield dwelling supply when the Ballarat North PSP 'Core Area' is included in June 2026, expected to deliver approximately 5,700 new lots.
- A future Ballarat North 'Expanded Area' PSP is expected to deliver approximately 2,600 dwellings, a further four years supply to complete the northern growth area.
- There is an estimated 30+ years future supply in the growth investigation areas of West of West and Northwest Growth Areas.
- Infrastructure in new greenfield areas is notably absent and would require significant investment by State and local governments to enable the development of these areas. While developers will contribute to the construction of some infrastructure in these new areas, it should be noted that the majority of costs will be associated with State road upgrades, major trunk infrastructure, schools, and other State facilities. To support new greenfield development, infrastructure investment is four times greater than the investment needed to support growth in established urban areas, which already benefit from access to services, transport, and green spaces.

Ballarat IGAF recommendations

Based on the findings above and to leverage off existing and known committed infrastructure, the IGAF recommends the following:

General

- 1 The City of Ballarat to implement a comprehensive and assertive program to plan, zone and incentivise development of additional housing in targeted areas of Ballarat's existing established area.
- 2 Council to deliver structure planning and rezoning for designated urban renewal areas within the municipality.
- 3 The City of Ballarat to report on residential land supply every two years. The report should focus on evaluating the progress in achieving Plan for Victoria housing targets for established (infill and urban renewal) and greenfield areas. The findings should focus on:
 - a. Sequencing and short, medium, and long-term recommendations of the IGAF remain adequate or need adjustment to meet current market needs, avoid price escalation, and/or respond to any shift in direction of State or local policy;
 - b. Identify any market constraints that have occurred in the interim two year period that may impact development viability; and
 - c. Identification of mechanisms and levers that Council can utilise to facilitate development and address barriers to development such as fragmentation of ownership of land, including but not limited to rates, capital works investment, lot consolidation, and working with service agencies to sequence essential sewer and water upgrades in advance of development.
- 4 The City of Ballarat in consultation with DTP should develop a funding and delivery strategy for transport infrastructure upgrades to 2051 to support achieving the *Plan for Victoria* growth targets (e.g. the Ballarat Link Road).

- 5 Planning for both urban renewal and greenfield growth precincts must include application of a development contributions plan/s that capture and levy development contribution for key State infrastructure (as well as local infrastructure).

In the short-term (to 2028):

- 6 Implement a Ballarat Settlement Boundary as per Plan for Victoria - Action 3 Carefully manage the outward sprawl of regional cities and towns.
- 7 City of Ballarat to commence its Urban Renewal Area Program to prepare Structure Plans for the Ballarat CBD Precinct, LaTrobe Saleyards Precinct and Wendouree Station Precinct.
- 8 To facilitate residential development in established areas of Ballarat, DTP will work with the City of Ballarat to finalise the following draft strategies to align with Plan for Victoria actions and progress relevant planning scheme amendments to the Ballarat Planning Scheme as follows:
 - a. Implement the Ballarat Housing Strategy via an amendment.
 - b. Implement the Ballarat Growth Areas Framework Plan. This must not result in an amendment for immediate rezoning of new greenfield land which should occur in line with the Plan for Victoria housing targets.
 - c. Prepare an amendment to rezone Scott Parade to facilitate higher density residential development.
 - d. Finalise and prepare an amendment to implement the draft Employment Lands Strategy. This should include confirmation that industrial land in the rest of the known urban renewal areas is not necessary for commercial/industrial purposes and identify where buffers can be reduced to sensitive uses. Undertaking this work will also confirm the residential opportunity at Ballarat Saleyards, as well as expanded residential opportunities at Wendouree, ahead of future spatial planning for these sites.
- 9 Investigate the residential threshold capacity for both the wider Wendouree Village, Creswick Road area and Ballarat Saleyard. This analysis should determine the maximum number of dwellings that can be developed in these areas before reaching infrastructure capacity in addition to any contamination challenges that will need to be resolved prior to introducing sensitive uses.
- 10 The City of Ballarat must initiate non-planning interventions to facilitate further infill (refer to Section 4.4.1)
- 11 The City of Ballarat must facilitate development in the existing Ballarat West PSP to maximise development in existing gazetted PSPs with infrastructure capacity.
- 12 VPA (DTP) should complete the Ballarat North PSP (Core Area) and implement via a planning scheme amendment to the Ballarat Planning Scheme.
- 13 The City of Ballarat must not progress additional rezoning of greenfield land in the Ballarat North (Expanded Area), North West, West of West, and Miners Rest in the short term.
- 14 The proposed rezoning at Cambrian Hill is not required in the short term. Golden Plains Shire Council addresses longer term strategic planning for Cambrian Hill in its *Growing Places Strategy – a Plan for Growth to 2051*.

In the medium term (2029–2033):

- 15** To progress urban renewal development, the City of Ballarat should extend its Urban Renewal Area Program to include:
 - a. Continue to incentivise development in targeted urban renewal areas of established Ballarat.
 - b. Finalise strategic planning on the wider Wendouree Village and Creswick Road area.
 - c. Prepare and finalise structure plan for the Creswick Road precinct, based on the capacity of any confirmed infrastructure upgrades.
 - d. If sensitive uses can be pursued in the Ballarat Saleyard site, prepare structure plan (or similar).
- 16** The City of Ballarat must continue to facilitate development in the existing Ballarat West PSP and the Ballarat North PSP (Core Area).
- 17** The City of Ballarat should commence strategic planning greenfield sites only if required as per the findings of the bi-annual review and in consultation with the State Government.

In the long term (2034 onwards):

- 18** Complete rezoning of all other potential renewal areas.
- 19** As per the findings of the biannual report prepared by the City of Ballarat, undertake the following in the longer term:
 - a. Monitor ongoing use of the Selkirk site and surrounds to determine the capacity to realise mixed-use urban renewal outcomes.
 - b. Continue facilitating development in existing PSP, infill and urban renewal areas.
 - c. Commence structure planning for other greenfield areas only if required.

Sequencing recommendations

The recommended growth sequence aims to maximise the use of existing infrastructure, guide resourcing for future strategic work and should be read in conjunction with the short, medium, and long-term recommendations above.

Urban Renewal (can occur now and concurrently):

- Ballarat CBD
- Wendouree Village Core Precinct
- Scott Parade
- Wendouree Village Wider Precinct
- Creswick Road
- Ballarat Saleyard
- Selkirk

Greenfield (sequenced):

- Ballarat North PSP (Expanded Area)
- West of West Growth Area / Miners Rest Quarry Hill
- North West Growth Area / Cambrian Hill

For a full list of sequencing recommendations, refer to **Section 5** of the report. It is noted that sequencing may be varied subject to agreement by the Minister for Planning and the City of Ballarat where the out of sequence criteria can be demonstrated.

Implementation

This IGAF, once approved by the Minister for Planning, should act as a guide to the City of Ballarat as it prioritises and progresses future amendments to their planning scheme. The IGAF should also be a reference for the City of Ballarat as it considers planning and other urban growth initiatives including the *Growth Area Framework Plan* for the North West and West-of-West growth areas.

Consistent with Ministerial Direction 18, the City of Ballarat will consult with the VPA on any planning scheme amendment that provides for rezoning of land within the IGAF area. This will give the IGAF formal status and will assist the City of Ballarat in giving effect to the directions recommended in the IGAF when decisions are made on future rezonings impacting Ballarat's growth challenge.

1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Purpose of the document

The *Ballarat Infrastructure and Growth Alignment Framework* (IGAF) provides high level strategic advice on the orderly staging and sequencing of residential growth in Ballarat to align with known and committed infrastructure provision in the City of Ballarat to meet the Plan for Victoria housing targets.

1.2 Why is this document required?

On 31 August 2022, the Victorian Planning Authority (VPA) was instructed by the former Minister for Planning, Lizzie Blandthorn to:

...undertake a high-level strategic review of Ballarat's proposed greenfield and urban renewal areas to inform the staging and sequencing of residential growth.

The instruction was given to address concerns over possible residential land shortage to accommodate growth in the City of Ballarat. The concern is compounded by the City of Ballarat's historical fragmented growth pattern and sequencing of development in areas that triggered an increased pressure for the State Government to fund and deliver new infrastructure.

In 2025, the Minister for Planning directed that the IGAF be updated to align with Plan for Victoria's directions for Ballarat and regional Victoria.

1.3 Scope

The Ballarat IGAF provides a high-level assessment of the following:

- Forecasted new dwellings aligned with the Plan for Victoria housing targets for Ballarat to 2051 at the 60/40 growth outlook.
- Current context of residential land supply in the City of Ballarat.
- Dwelling yields for known greenfield areas and potential dwelling capacity in chosen urban renewal areas.
- Whether there is sufficient land supply to maintain a 15-year dwelling supply.
- The current context of existing infrastructure and planned infrastructure to support growth.
- Notional sequencing of residential land supply to support orderly infrastructure provision.
- Potential planning mechanisms and other implementation processes to support residential growth.

The IGAF relies on existing information including overarching housing targets set by Plan for Victoria for the City of Ballarat (released February 2025), the settlement planning and strategic policy in the Ballarat Planning Scheme and strategic planning studies currently underway by the City of Ballarat.

1.4 Growth areas considered

The IGAF report considers the following sites selected based on locations identified in the Ballarat Planning Scheme, strategic planning policies, and consultation with the City of Ballarat. The report also provides a review of existing infill land, focusing on areas already zoned for residential use (refer to **Figure 1** overleaf for a spatial plan of the sites above):

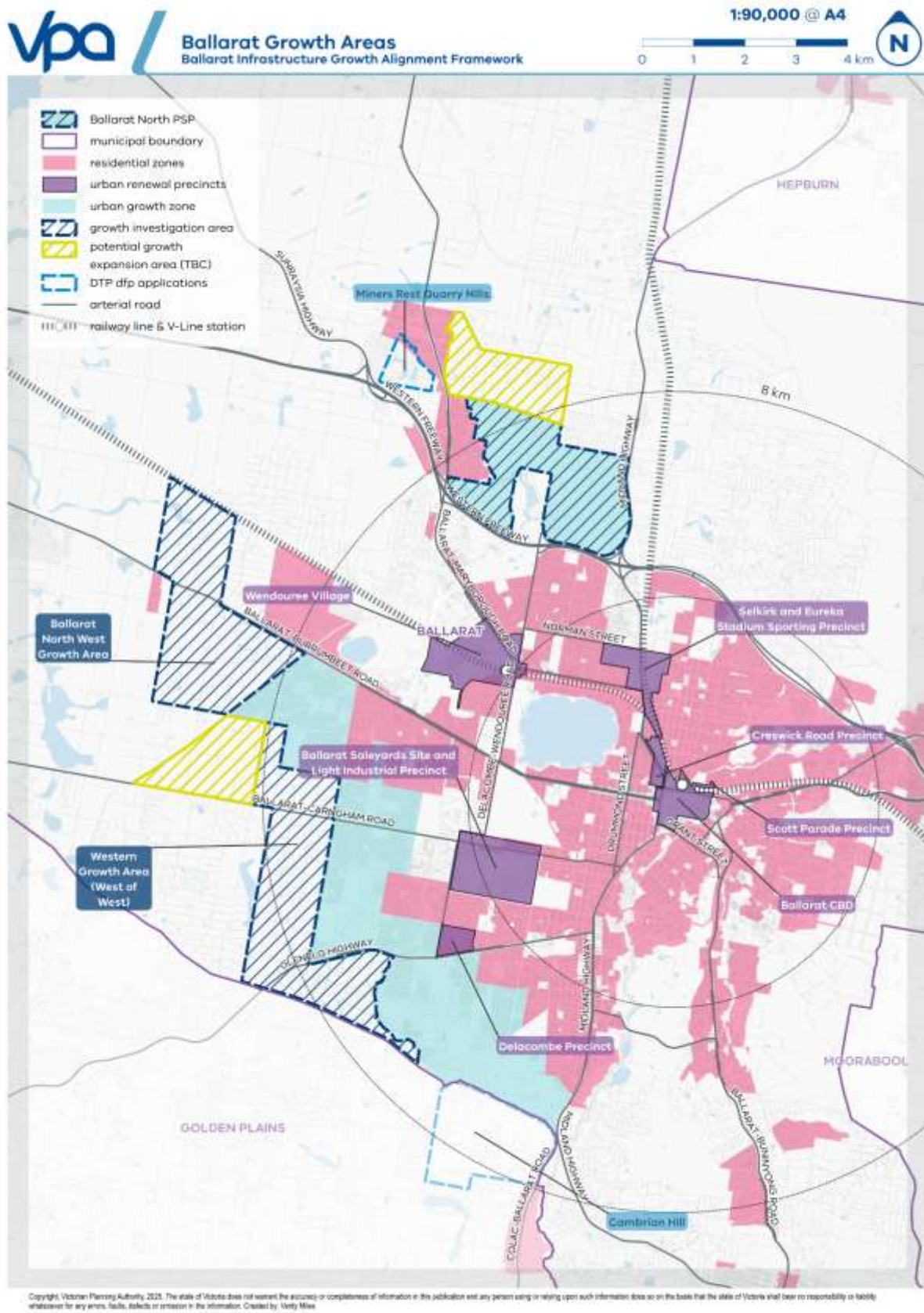
Urban renewal sites:

- Wendouree Village
- Scott Parade
- Creswick Road
- Delacombe
- Ballarat CBD
- Selkirk Precinct (integrated with or independent of Eureka Stadium Sporting Precinct)
- Ballarat Saleyards Site and Light Industrial Precinct (commercial / light Industrial redevelopment)

Greenfield sites:

- Alfredton West Precinct Structure Plan
- Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan
- Ballarat North PSP Core Area
- Ballarat North Expanded Area
- Western Growth Area (i.e. West of West)
- North West Growth Area
- Miner's Rest (Former Quarry)
- Cambrian Hill (Golden Plains Shire)

Figure 1: Ballarat Growth Areas⁵



1.5 Strategic policy context

Plan for Victoria

Plan for Victoria was released in February 2025 and provides a 30-year blueprint for how Victoria will support future population and dwelling growth.

Key aspects of the plan that are relevant to the Ballarat IGAF include:

- The implementation of housing targets for every Victorian local government area for the period 2023-2051. The plan sets a target of 46,900 net new dwellings to be delivered in the City of Ballarat to 2051.
- The implementation of sub-targets for new dwellings in greenfield and established areas of Victoria's major regional cities. In the City of Ballarat, it is intended that 40 per cent of new dwellings will be delivered in greenfield areas (18,900 dwellings), whilst the remaining 60 percent of dwellings to be delivered in established areas (28,000 dwellings).
- A plan to establish clear regional growth boundaries for major regional cities such as Ballarat, to manage outward sprawl and encourage more homes in the centre of town.
 - The regional boundaries are intended to direct more homes where they're needed – close to jobs, transport, shops, schools, healthcare, and services – and produce more affordable housing options for future generations.
 - The regional boundaries also seek to ensure that regional cities continue to grow in a sustainable way – preserving natural assets such as agricultural land, parks, forests, and natural resources.
 - The boundaries are to be developed in partnership with regional councils, and discussions have commenced with the City of Ballarat.
 - Any future expansions of the regional boundary would only occur "if this is consistent with the vision for these places and if and when councils and other authorities can provide the necessary infrastructure (such as water and sewerage) for more people."

Victoria's Housing Statement

In September 2023, the Victorian Government released *Victoria's Housing Statement: The decade ahead 2024-2034*, setting a target to build 800,000 homes in Victoria over the next decade.

The Housing Statement includes a clear message that continuous sprawl is not the solution. A better solution to meeting growth demands is a balanced approach where there is also a focus to unlock more housing in established areas.

The Housing Strategy identified the Ballarat IGAF and the Ballarat North PSP, currently being prepared by DTP (VPA), as two of the 21 priority projects for the State. The Ballarat North PSP project is expected to be delivered by June 2026.

1.5.1 State planning policy

Clause 11 – Settlement

Clause 11 in all Victorian planning schemes aims to ensure sufficient supply of land for housing and other land uses, and ensure planning facilitates sustainable development that takes full

advantage of existing settlement patterns and investment in transport, utility, social, community and commercial infrastructure and services.

Clause 11.01-1S identifies Ballarat as a major regional city where investment and growth should be focused. Ballarat is the only major regional city (the others being Geelong and Bendigo) that does not currently have a settlement boundary. A settlement boundary is currently being drafted as part of Plan for Victoria implementation, and will consider the following policy with regard to form:

Manage the expansion of settlements by:

- *Creating and reinforcing settlement boundaries. Where no settlement boundary is identified, limit the expansion of a settlement to the extent of existing urban zoned land.*
- *Promoting and capitalising on opportunities for urban renewal and infill redevelopment.*
- *Limiting urban sprawl and direct growth into existing settlements.*
- *Develop compact urban areas that are based around existing or planned activity centres to maximise accessibility to facilities and services.*

Provide for growth in population and development of facilities and services across a regional or sub-regional network in accordance with housing targets.

Plan for development and investment opportunities that make best use of existing and planned transport infrastructure.

Clause 11.01-1R further strengthens Ballarat as a major regional centre for focusing regional investment and growth in the Central Highlands region.

Clause 11.02-1S requires that supply of urban land is considered on a municipal basis. Relevant strategies include:

Ensure the ongoing provision of land and supporting infrastructure to support sustainable urban development.

Ensure that sufficient land is available to meet forecast demand.

Plan to accommodate projected population growth over at least a 15-year period with provide clear direction on locations where this growth should occur. Residential land supply will be considered on a municipal basis, rather than a town-by-town basis.

Planning for urban growth should consider:

- *Opportunities for the consolidation, redevelopment and intensification of existing urban areas.*
- *Neighbourhood character and landscape considerations.*
- *The limits of land capability and natural hazards and environmental quality.*
- *Service limitations and the costs of providing infrastructure.*

Monitor development trends and land supply and demand for housing and industry.

Clause 11.02-3S aims to manage the sequence of growth. Relevant strategies include:

Define preferred development sequences in areas of growth to better coordinate infrastructure planning and funding.

Ensure that new land is released in areas of growth in a timely fashion to facilitate coordinated and cost-efficient provision of local and regional infrastructure.

Require new development to make a financial contribution to the provision of infrastructure such as community facilities, public transport and roads.

Improve the coordination and timing of infrastructure and service delivery in areas of growth.

Support opportunities to co-locate facilities.

Ensure that planning for water supply, sewerage and drainage works receives high priority in early planning for areas of growth.

Clause 16 – Housing

Clause 16.01-1S aims to ensure housing is well-located, integrated, and diverse to meet community needs. Relevant strategies include:

Plan to accommodate housing targets by ensuring zones and overlays deliver sufficient realisable development capacity. For Ballarat this includes:

<i>Housing Target</i>	<i>46,900 dwellings</i>
<i>Greenfield Area Target</i>	<i>18,900 dwellings</i>
<i>Established Area Target</i>	<i>28,000 dwellings</i>

Increase the proportion of housing in urban areas with good access to opportunities and services (including under-utilised urban land) and reduce the share of new dwellings in greenfield, fringe and dispersed development areas.

Encourage higher density housing development on sites that are well located in relation to jobs, services and public transport.

Identify opportunities for increased residential densities to help consolidate urban areas.

Clause 18 – Transport

Clause 18.01-1S aims to ensure land use and transport planning are integrated in a way that facilitates access to social, cultural and economic opportunities. Relevant strategies include:

Plan and develop a transport system that facilitates:

- *The best use of existing social and economic infrastructure.*
- *A reduction in the distances people have to travel to access jobs and services.*

Plan the timely delivery of transport infrastructure and services to support changing land use and associated transport demands.

Plan the use of land adjacent to the transport system having regard to the current and future development and operation of the transport system.

Support urban development that makes jobs and services more accessible:

- *In accordance with forecast demand.*
- *By taking advantage of all available modes of transport.*

1.5.2 Approved City of Ballarat strategies

Several approved City of Ballarat strategies have informed the settlement policy, including, but not limited to:

- **Today, Tomorrow, Together – The Ballarat Strategy, 2015**

This document sets the long-term direction for how future challenges should be addressed. Relevant actions from this document include support for the 10-minute city and supporting infill development.

- **Ballarat Long Term Growth Options Investigations, 2018**

The purpose of the Ballarat Long Term Growth Options Investigations is to undertake a feasibility study into future development merit and potential of the four nominated growth investigation areas: Western, North Western, Northern and Eastern. The study aims to determine where this long-term growth (post 2040) should be allocated.

- **Ballarat Community Infrastructure Plan 2022–2037**

A key purpose of this document is to provide clear direction about the City of Ballarat's community infrastructure investment priorities over the next 15 years.

- **Making Ballarat Central: The CBD Strategy, 2017–2021**

The Ballarat CBD Strategy is a long-term plan to guide growth and change in the Central Business District over the next 20–25 years.

1.5.3 Current City of Ballarat strategic planning work

The City of Ballarat also has several strategic planning studies underway to further inform an overall settlement framework. These include, but are not limited to:

- **Housing Strategy 2041**

Ballarat City Council's *Housing Strategy* establishes a framework for managing population and housing growth to achieve a 50/50 growth target. It provides objectives for the following:

How many dwellings do we need to accommodate our projected population growth?

What kind of dwellings do our diverse and future communities need?

Where should those dwellings be located?

What should they look like?

- **Central Business District Urban Design Framework and Structure Plan**

The *CBD Structure Plan* will include an urban design framework with a focus on future character and built form within the Ballarat CBD that balances the need to accommodate sustainable (residential and commercial) growth, while respecting the highly valued heritage values and character within the core of the CBD.

- **Miners Rest Township Plan**

The *Miners Rest Township Plan* is progressing as Planning Scheme Amendment C235ball and proposes to implement the key land use planning directions contained in the *Miners Rest Township Plan* into the *Ballarat Planning Scheme*. At the time of writing, the Panel report has been released.

- **Growth Area Framework Plan for the Western and North-Western Growth Areas**

The *Growth Area Framework Plan* for the proposed Western and North-Western Growth Areas has been adopted by Council. It identifies high-level infrastructure requirements and provides further guidance on the sequence and timing of long term future precinct structure planning.

1.5.4 Additional considerations

Planning Practice Note 90

PPN90 requires the following:

Plan to accommodate projected population growth over at least a 15-year period and provide clear direction on locations where growth should occur. Residential land supply will be considered on a municipal basis, rather than a town-by-town basis.

Planning for urban growth should consider:

- *Opportunities for the consolidation, redevelopment and intensification of existing urban areas.*
- *Neighbourhood character and landscape considerations.*
- *The limits of land capability and natural hazards and environmental quality.*
- *Service limitations and the costs of providing infrastructure.*

Central Highlands Regional Growth Plan 2014

The *Central Highlands Regional Growth Plan* sets out regional approach to land use planning for this region. The Plan seeks to promote growth in Ballarat, with five 'Future Directions'. Relevant Future Directions include:

- *Support development and investment that is consistent with Ballarat's...*
- *Facilitate growth of the city, particularly through planned development...through infill opportunities.*

Infrastructure Victoria: Our Home Choices, March 2023

Infrastructure Victoria is an independent advisory board that provides infrastructure strategy, advice to the State government and publishes research on matters related to infrastructure. This document shows more choice and housing diversity is needed to meet people's needs as Victoria's population grows. Key recommendations include:

- *Prioritise urban renewal precincts for development, with streamlined planning approvals.*
- *Set targets in each precinct for the number, type and size of new homes.*
- *Develop suitable housing demonstration projects that specifically include 3-bedroom homes.*

1.6 How the Ballarat IGAF will be given effect

The Ballarat IGAF will be given effect via Ministerial Direction 18. Ministerial Direction 18 is a directive that ensures consideration of the Victorian Planning Authority's (VPA) advice in planning scheme amendments that involve the rezoning of land.

When a planning authority prepares an amendment to rezone land, they are required to consult with the VPA and take its advice into account. The Ballarat IGAF is considered the advice. Ministerial Direction 18 is aimed at maintaining consistency with strategic plans and policies, ensuring that amendments align with the broader objectives set by the VPA. Additionally, the planning authority must document in its explanatory report how the amendment addresses the VPA's advice, its response to it, and how it implements the intended outcomes of the VPA.

More generally, the Department of Transport and Planning will monitor the alignment of strategic planning work and any proposed planning scheme amendments with the Ballarat IGAF and Plan for Victoria including the *Housing Strategy* and the *Growth Area Framework Plan for the Western and North-Western Growth Area*.

2 DWELLING DEMAND

The Ballarat IGAF has adopted the *Plan for Victoria's* 2051 housing targets for future growth in the City of Ballarat, including:

- Total dwelling growth of 46,900 dwellings, or 1,675 dwellings per annum to 2051.
- The 60% non-greenfield target of 28,000 dwellings, will require an average of 1,005 dwellings per year to 2051.
- The 40% greenfield target of 18,900 dwellings, will require an average of 670 dwellings per year to 2051.

Historically, the average number of New Dwelling Approvals (NDA) granted each year in the past decade is approximately 1,150 per annum⁶, which included a spike during the pandemic period (1,750 per annum between 2020–2023).

Table 2 – Council's *Housing Strategy* indicates a breakdown of future dwelling needs by dwelling type to 2041 to show how growth may be accommodated to deliver greater diversity in housing stock than what is provided currently. The strategy indicates stronger percentage growth in flats/apartments and other attached dwellings, and attributes this to anticipated future shifts in household composition, namely more lone person households.

Table 2: Ballarat IGAF dwelling projections by dwelling type, City of Ballarat

	2021	2026	2031	2036	2041	Change 21-41	Change p.a. 21-41 (%)
Separate house	42,262	47,518	52,753	58,712	65,087	+ 22,825	+ 54%
Attached dwelling	6,335	7,488	8,667	10,024	11,509	5,174	+ 82%
Flat or apartment	1,409	1,619	1,824	2,053	2,332	923	+ 66%
Other	198	207	210	210	237	39	+ 20%
All housing types	50,204	56,833	63,454	71,000	79,165	28,961	+ 58%

City of Ballarat Housing Strategy, 2041

⁶ Australian Bureau of Statistics, New Dwellings Approvals Data 2012-2025 (financial years)

3 DWELLING CAPACITY AND NEED

The Victorian State Planning Policy Framework requires planning authorities to:

Plan to accommodate projected population growth over at least a 15-year period and provide clear direction on locations where growth should occur. Residential land supply will be considered on a municipal basis, rather than a town-by-town basis.

DTP's Amendment VC283 embeds Plan for Victoria housing targets to 2051 in the Planning Scheme. State Policy continues to support greenfield, urban renewal and existing infill land as all part of the equation to meet land supply to support Ballarat's growth. It is noted that the current Planning Policy Framework does not specify whether the 15-year land supply should consist solely of zoned land, ready for planning permit applications for housing, or include unzoned land identified for future growth.

The following dwelling capacity analysis illustrates the capacity for the City of Ballarat to cater for new housing, considering both areas ready for development (zoned) and those earmarked for future development (unzoned).

While the City of Ballarat's Housing Strategy 2041 aims for a 50/50 growth split between infill and greenfield development, the Plan for Victoria sets a 60/40 growth split aspiration for Ballarat. The Ballarat IGAF notes both these targets align with the creation of a compact city model. The delivery of a higher share of new housing in established areas with existing infrastructure capacity would be associated with several benefits.

Infrastructure Victoria's 2023 research '*Choosing Victoria's future: 5 urban development scenarios*' identifies the benefits of the compact city model and the downsides of sprawl, including the following:

- Across Victoria, infrastructure in a dispersed city costs the government about \$59,000 extra for every new home built, compared to a compact city.
- More land for agriculture, biodiversity and wildlife habitat. A sprawling, dispersed city consumes an extra thousands of hectares of land compared to a compact city.
- People living in dispersed cities spend more time in congested traffic to get to jobs and services.
- People would use more public transport with clear positive environmental, physical and mental health outcomes.
- Offer businesses better opportunities to hire great staff and connect with customers and markets. Victorians would be up to \$43 billion better off by 2056 with more compact cities.

If Ballarat continues a business-as-usual 70% greenfield growth scenario, State government funding will average over \$50 million per year (70% of 1,200 dwellings) to support that growth.

3.1 Existing zoned greenfield land

It is estimated that approximately 16 years of dwelling supply can be accommodated on existing greenfield zoned land including:

- Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan
- Alfredton West Precinct Structure Plan, and

- Smaller greenfield sites such as Miners Rest and Brown Hill.

The number of years assumes development on all remaining developable land at 40:60 greenfield to infill ratio, which would direct 670 new dwellings to greenfield areas and 1,005 new dwellings to established areas per annum.

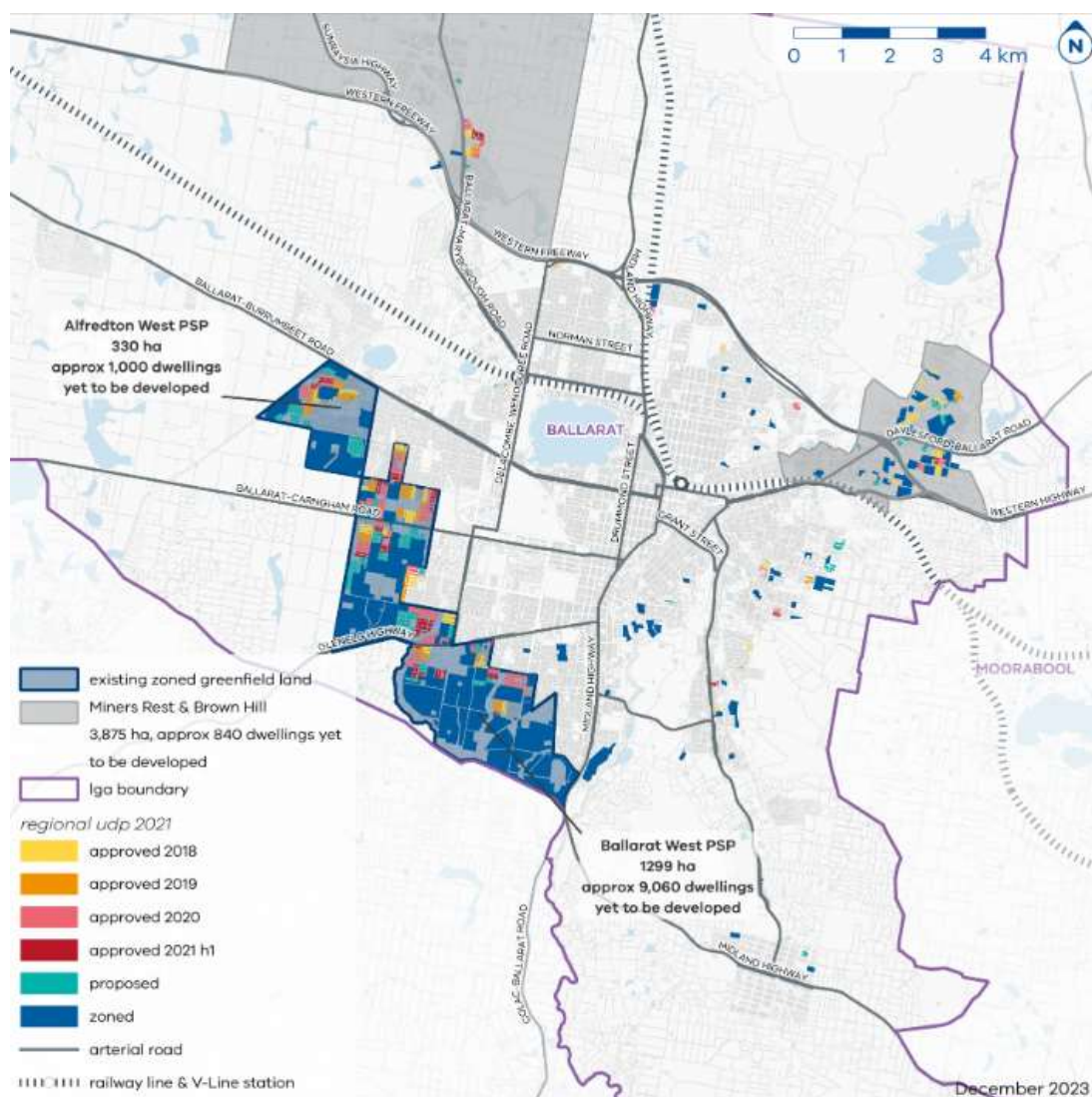


Figure 2: Existing Zoned Greenfield Land

It is understood that construction of dwellings on all remaining developable land may be unrealistic or unfeasible because of land fragmentation and the insurmountable challenges associated with servicing land, especially in the southern region of the Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan.

Data from the City of Ballarat indicates that the presence of small, fragmented land parcels in certain greenfield areas may not pose as significant a challenge as previously thought. The City of Ballarat is actively processing planning applications for subdivisions on land parcels as small as 1.3 hectares.

Additionally, Central Highlands Water's approved funding of \$17.3 million⁷ for significant sewer assets to support Ballarat West underscores its commitment to infrastructure, further enhancing development prospects in areas such as the Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan.

While precinct structure plans such as Ballarat West and Alfredton West require development to achieve at least 15 dwellings per net developable hectare, advice from the City of Ballarat suggests that newer developments are being delivered at a higher density, of up to 17.64 dwellings per net developable hectare. If the current trend persists, higher densities will continue to be realised and the total number of dwellings will be higher than originally anticipated.

Despite some reservations regarding the developability of land in these existing greenfield areas, the data obtained at the time of writing suggests otherwise.

Table 3 below provides an overview of projected dwelling capacity and estimated years of supply. Projected dwelling capacity has been collected from a range of sources, including the City of Ballarat.

Table 3: Estimated years of dwelling supply in existing zoned greenfield areas under a business-as-usual scenario (i.e. 70% of dwellings developed on greenfield land)

Growth areas	Dwelling capacity assumption	Annual dwelling rate (70% of 1,675 p.a.)	Estimated years of dwelling supply
Ballarat West PSP	9,060	1173	7.7
Alfredton West PSP	1,000	1173	0.9
Other greenfield (Miners Rest, Brown Hill)	840	1173	0.7
Total	10,900		9 years of dwelling supply

Table 4 represents under **the Plan for Victoria scenario in which 40 per cent of new dwellings are accommodated in greenfield areas, the amount of zoned supply would increase to approximately 16 years.**

Table 4: Estimated years of dwelling supply in existing zoned greenfield areas achieving the Plan for Victoria growth scenario (i.e. 40% of dwellings developed on greenfield land)

Growth areas	Dwelling capacity assumption	Annual dwelling rate (40% of 1,675 p.a.)	Estimated years of dwelling supply
Ballarat West PSP	9,060	670	13.5
Alfredton West PSP	1,000	670	1.5
Other greenfield (Miners Rest, Brown Hill)	840	670	1.3
Total	10,900		16 years of dwelling supply

⁷ Major Project 1 – Ballarat Sewer Growth Project – Ballarat West UGZ southern section.

3.2 Future greenfield land

Future greenfield land is separated into two categories: zoned and unzoned.

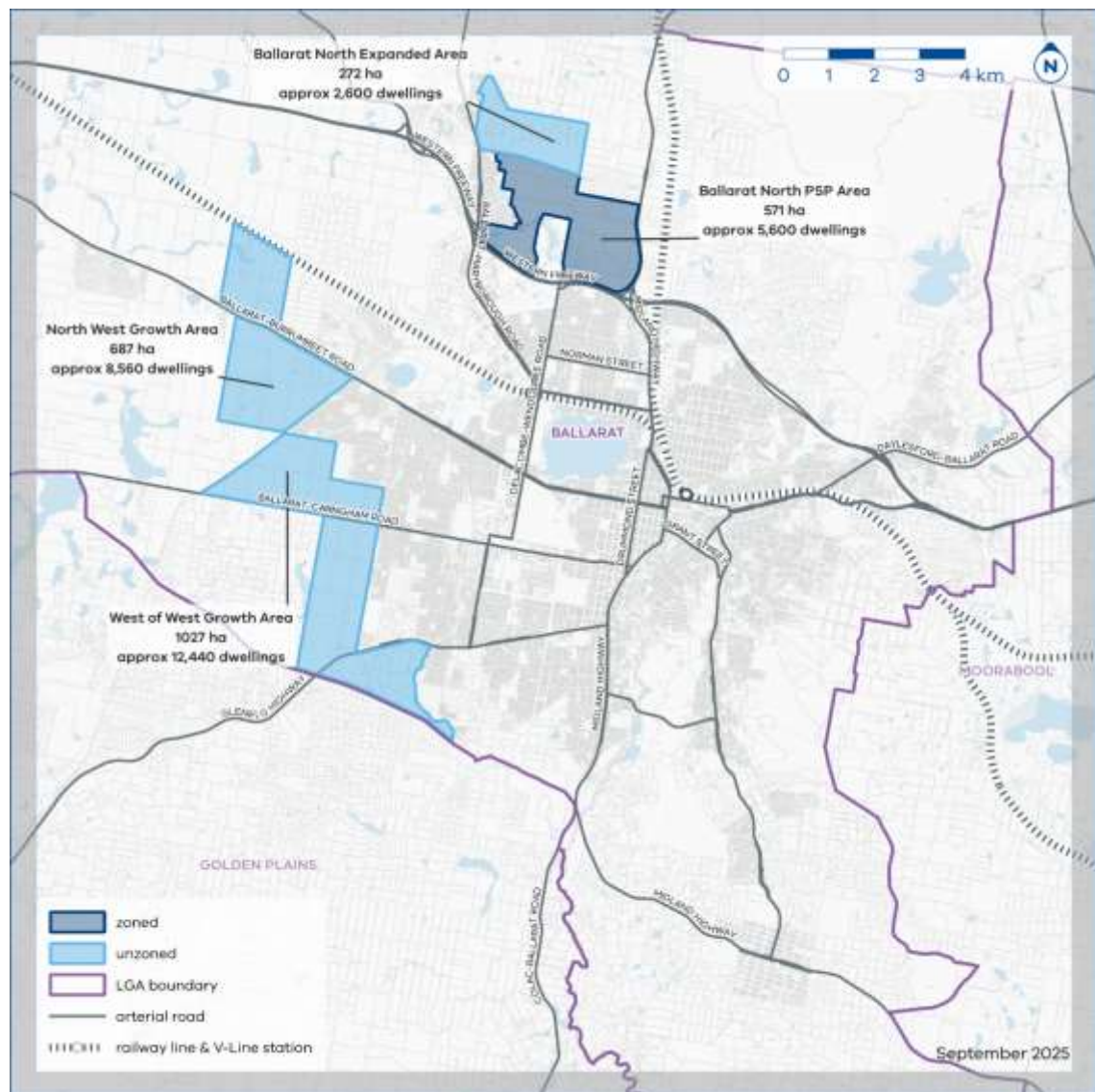


Figure 3: Future greenfield land

3.2.1 Zoned

Precinct structure plan in progress (Ballarat North Core Area)

The draft Ballarat North precinct structure plan (PSP) is expected to accommodate approximately 5,600 dwellings, at an average of 20 dwellings per net developable hectare.

The Ballarat North PSP could increase dwelling supply by an additional eight years. If total current land availability includes this area, greenfield dwelling supply would increase to approximately 25 years if the number of dwellings built in greenfield areas remains strong.

Table 5: Estimated years of dwelling supply in existing and future zoned greenfield areas

Growth areas	Dwelling capacity assumption	Annual dwelling rate (40% of 1,675)	Estimated years of dwelling supply
Ballarat West PSP	9,060	670	13.5
Alfredton West PSP	1,000	670	1.5
Other greenfield (Miners Rest, Brown Hill)	840	670	1.3
Ballarat North PSP (Core Area)	5,700	670	8.5
Total	16,600		25 years of dwelling supply

3.2.2 Unzoned

Ballarat North (Expanded Area)

The Ballarat North growth area includes two parts, the Core Area for which planning is underway (Ballarat North PSP) discussed above at section 3.2.1, and an Expanded Area to its north. The area was not assessed in *Ballarat's Long-Term Growth Options Investigation*. The Expanded Area could contribute approximately 2,600 dwellings, equating to an additional four years of dwelling supply at the Plan for Victoria 60:40 growth scenario. This would complete planning of the northern growth area of Ballarat.

If the Expanded Area were to be included, it would bring the total greenfield dwelling supply up to 29 years. With the Expanded Area the *Plan for Victoria* greenfield target to 2051 would be achieved without the need to rezone further greenfield land.

North West and West of West Growth Areas

The North West and West of West Growth Areas are large and have the potential to accommodate a combined total of 21,000 new dwellings. This capacity translates to over 30 years of greenfield dwelling supply, assuming the 60/40.

3.3 Other greenfield land

Two additional greenfield sites, Miners Rest (Former Quarry) and Cambrian Hill, were examined as they were developer-led amendments being considered under the Department of Transport and Planning's Development Facilitation Program in addition to being identified in the Ballarat and Golden Plains Planning Schemes respectively.

The Miners Rest (former quarry site) forms part of the broader *Miners Rest Township Plan* (November 2019) study area. The quarry ceased extraction in 2017 and is currently being rehabilitated. The quarry is now flooded and is closed to the public. The *Miners Rest Township Plan* acknowledges that the site has the potential for future redevelopment opportunities.

Cambrian Hill

Despite its location in a separate municipality, it has been evaluated within the IGAF report because it abuts the existing Ballarat West PSP area and has been identified in Golden Plains Shire Northern Settlement Strategy as an area for potential residential growth. Residents of Cambrian Hill access services in the Ballarat area, as it is closer than the main town in Golden

Plains Shire, Bannockburn, which is over 50 kilometres away. Cambrian Hill is approximately 8 kilometres south of the Ballarat CBD.

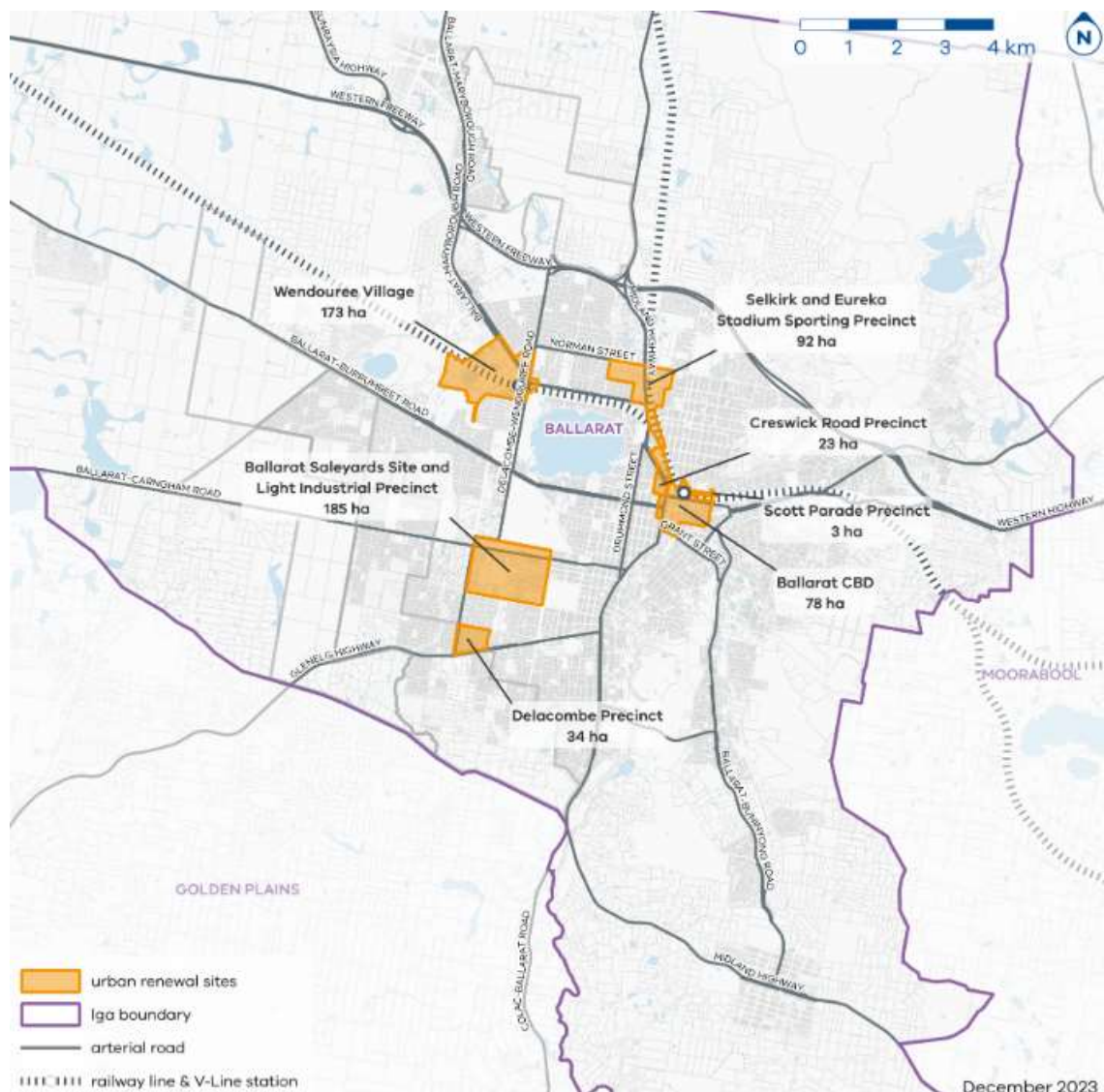
The proposal could yield approximately 3,000 dwellings. However, at the time of writing, the developer led amendment is no longer being considered by the Development Facilitation Program.

3.4 Urban renewal sites

Urban renewal sites considered include:

- Wendouree Village
- Scott Parade
- Creswick Road
- Delacombe
- Ballarat CBD
- Selkirk Precinct (integrated with or independent of Eureka Stadium Sporting Precinct)
- Ballarat Saleyards Site and Light Industrial Precinct (commercial/light industrial redevelopment)

Figure 5: Urban renewal sites



The VPA conducted built form modelling for several urban renewal sites, excluding Selkirk, Delacombe, and the Ballarat CBD, for the following reasons:

- Selkirk was not modelled despite being a promising mixed-use urban renewal opportunity with residential potential. The landowner indicated no intention to relocate, suggesting the site will likely remain industrial in the short to medium term.
- The Saleyards site was not modelled due to its comparatively high level of contamination, presenting significant challenges for modelling. Further, the City of Ballarat's current strategy, *Today, Tomorrow, Together*, suggests that repurposing the site for commercial, light industrial, or other uses may be more appropriate, thereby de-emphasising residential development. It is advised that modelling should proceed only after obtaining a more comprehensive understanding of the site's suitability for sensitive uses.

- Delacombe was excluded as it is largely developed for residential purposes, with many large lots over 1,500 square metres. Its proximity to the Delacombe Town Centre makes it a suitable development area, and there are ongoing smaller unit applications which are proposing units in the range of 200 square metres in size. However, due to the unpredictability of market uptake, this site was not included in the modelling.

Built form modelling undertaken by the VPA for the remaining urban renewal precincts indicates there is significant potential capacity for these precincts to contribute to housing supply.

The modelling is a theoretical estimate of what could be achieved. Achieving these dwelling yields is dependent on transition of industrial and some commercial land uses out of precincts. There is short-medium-term potential for smaller scale redevelopment to be realised across several precincts, namely Scott Parade and Wendouree Village as well as Ballarat CBD.

The modelling suggests that some areas could potentially accommodate structures up to eight storeys. However, it's important to note the current limited market for apartment-style developments in the City of Ballarat, with only a few existing examples. Despite this, planning is not just for the short term. The development of these sites, though ideally expedited, could span many years, and the market for apartment residences may evolve in that time.

The accompanying table illustrates the modelling for various urban renewal sites, where **the lower figure represents exclusively townhouses, and the higher figure includes a mix of townhouses and apartments up to eight storeys.**

Table 6: Potential yield in urban renewal precincts

Residential area	Potential dwelling yield (2–8 storeys)*
Scott Parade Precinct	100–240
Creswick Road Precinct	1,600–4,700
Selkirk and Eureka Precinct	3,900–9,600
Wendouree Village Precinct	8,390–22,720
Ballarat CBD	4,000 ⁸
Total	17,990–41,260

Source: VPA, City of Ballarat *Note this is a theoretical supply based on full redevelopment at between 2–8 storeys

The modelling undertaken was at a high level and was based on 29 constraint considerations which excluded modelling on parcels under 300 sqm, within a strata title, recently subdivided, within an existing reserve, and several other zones which were not deemed developable. It also applied significant discounts on land within a heritage overlay, where there is cultural sensitivity, where there are significant vegetation and others, to acknowledge that while development in these areas is possible, it is not straightforward, thus reducing the expectation of high yields from such properties.

Even under the most conservative scenario, where no apartments are constructed and only townhouses occupy the land in urban renewal areas, an estimated 18,000 homes could be built, or 17 years non-greenfield supply.

⁸ City of Ballarat, Housing Capacity Assessment Report (prepared by Tract, April 2022)

It is acknowledged that developing in the CBD presents additional challenges due to heritage constraints. Excluding the CBD's potential for additional dwellings, there remains capacity for approximately 14,000 homes in the lower scenario in existing urban renewal sites.

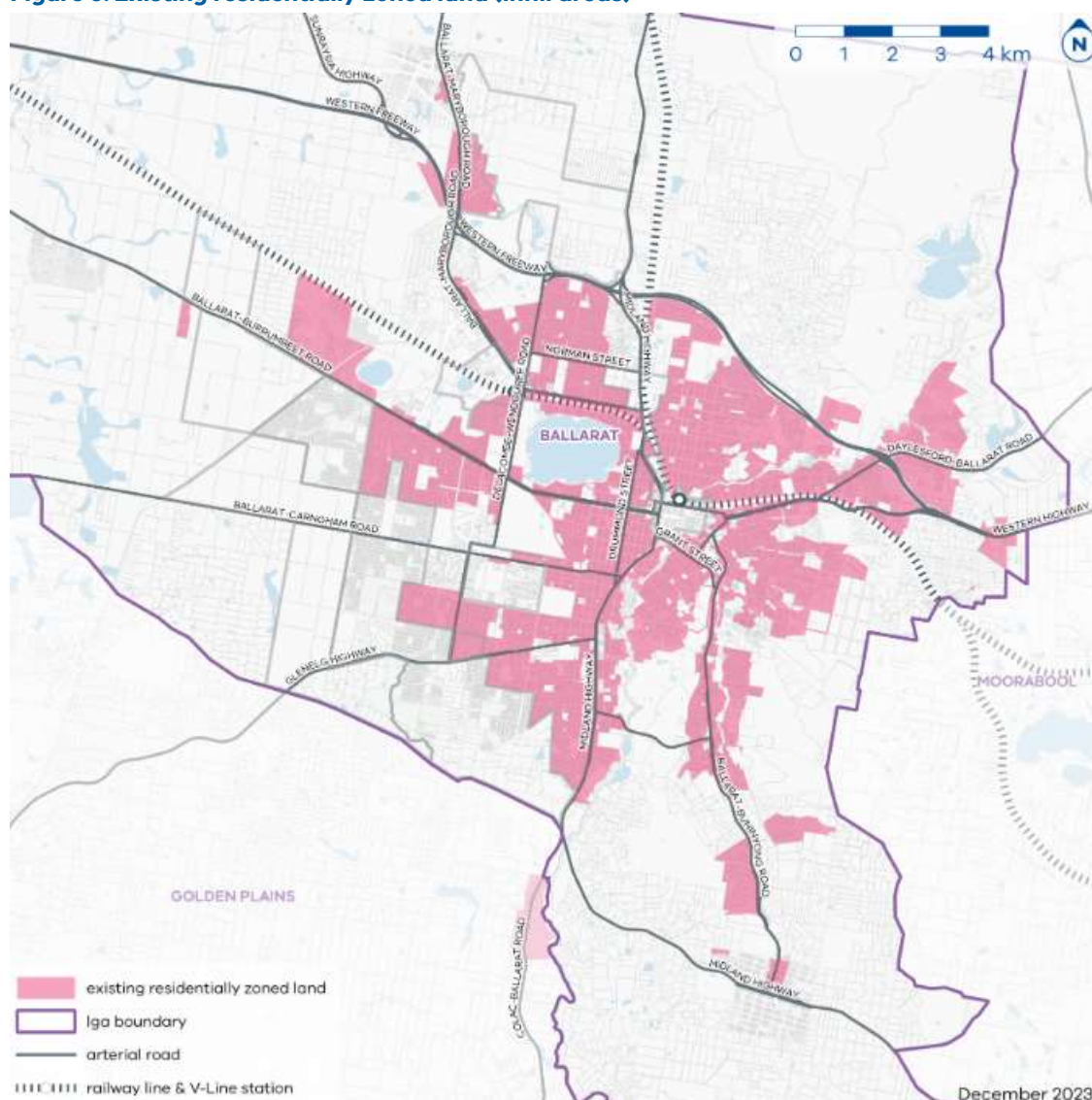
If developed at the upper yield of 41,000 dwellings, urban renewal sites in Ballarat may provide up to 40 years supply, and deliver the total non-greenfield housing target of 28,000.

3.5 Existing infill land

Although rezoning urban renewal land for development, creating a structure plan, and potentially remediating contaminated sites may take time, it is important to recognise the considerable untapped residential potential within existing areas that are already zoned for residential use.

The image below shows all residentially zoned land in the City of Ballarat.

Figure 6: Existing residentially zoned land (infill areas)



The City of Ballarat's Draft Housing Strategy 2023 has identified a theoretical capacity to accommodate approximately 23,000 dwellings on land zoned: Residential Growth Zone (RGZ), General Residential Zone (GRZ), Neighbourhood Residential Zone (NRZ), Mixed Use Zone (MUZ),

Township Zone (TZ) and Low Density Residential Zone (LDRZ)⁹. The Draft Housing Strategy further estimates that applying Change Areas in strategic locations could unlock an additional 10,000–11,000 potential dwellings.

The historical trend of established residential areas accounting for approximately 30% of dwelling approvals has seen between 310–800 dwellings approved each year since 2019.

Existing residentially zoned land holds significant untapped potential. While the capacity modelling in the City of Ballarat’s Draft Housing Strategy 2023 has excluded certain land based on size, heritage value, and other factors, market-driven elements could further impact the realistic development potential of that theoretical capacity.

Despite these uncertainties, unlocking even 20% of 33,000 theoretical capacity would yield approximately 6,800 additional dwellings, translating to between six to seven years (assuming between 60% of future development is accommodated in established areas). This projection does not include potential contributions from the Ballarat CBD or Urban Renewal areas, which would further increase potential dwelling availability.

At the time of writing, no analysis has been conducted to determine a realistic market uptake of this theoretical dwelling capacity. It is understood that the City of Ballarat is considering undertaking this analysis to supplement the foundational data underpinning the Draft Housing Strategy.

3.6 Summary

Overall, the review of dwelling supply and potential dwelling capacity indicates that there is:

- ~ 25 years of zoned greenfield dwelling supply in the existing Ballarat West PSP, Alfredton West PSP, other smaller greenfield sites such as Miners Rest and Brown Hill in addition to the Ballarat North (Core Area) should all remaining land be developed at a 60/40 infill to greenfield ratio.
- ~ 29 years of dwelling supply if the Ballarat North PSP (Expanded Area) were also included in the overall supply of available greenfield land at a 60/40 greenfield to infill ratio to complete the northern growth area.
- The capacity for ~23 years dwelling supply of new dwellings within existing residential zoned land, with a large proportion of this in the General Residential Zone (GRZ).
- The capacity for a minimum 14 years or +14,000 new dwellings across urban renewal precincts.
- The capacity for ~4,000 new dwellings in the Ballarat city centre.

⁹ City of Ballarat, Draft Housing Strategy, 2023

4 Unlocking land: a review of infrastructure demand and availability

The review of infrastructure focuses primarily on State transport needs as well as sewer and water.

Other matters, including bushfires, schools, retail areas, and open spaces, were investigated, however, many of these matters can usually be addressed during the precinct planning stage.

However, resolving infrastructure challenges, particularly state transport upgrades, at the precinct planning scale presents more challenges. While not impossible, finding solutions at the precinct level is often suboptimal. It is far more effective to address these as threshold issues prior to precinct planning.

4.1 Existing zoned greenfield land

Existing zoned greenfield land includes (refer to Figure 7 overleaf):

- Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan;
- Alfredton West Precinct Structure Plan; and
- Smaller greenfield sites such as Miners Rest and Brown Hill.

The smaller greenfield sites are progressing as they are minor in size, dispersed, and have a limited number of dwellings remaining for development, making it feasible for them to continue as they are. The primary focus of this section is on the Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan and the Alfredton West Precinct Structure Plan.

Sewer upgrades are approved to facilitate the continued growth of the Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan.

The VPA is aware of the current challenges in extending sewer services to the southern portion of the Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan area.

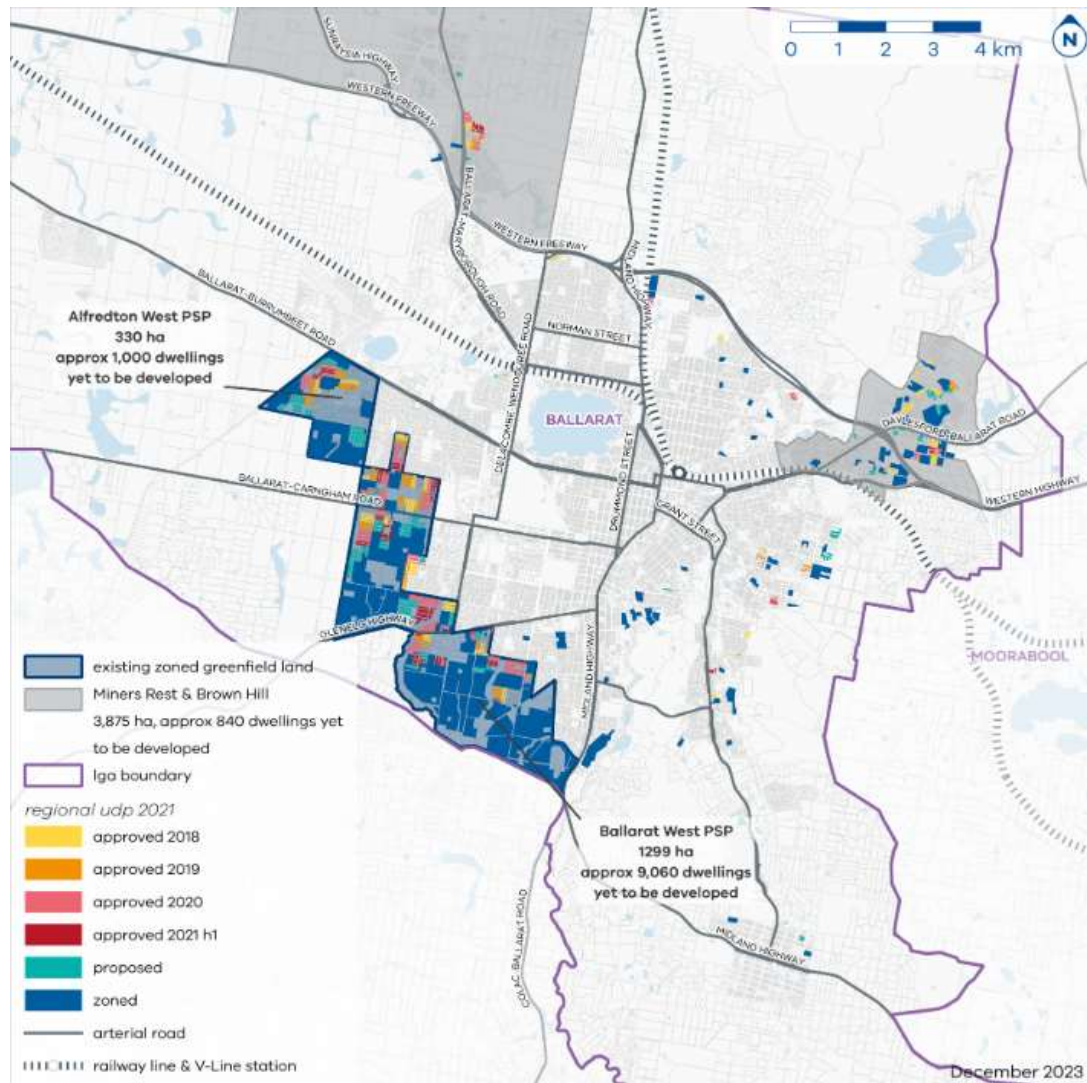
Discussions with Central Highlands Water have revealed plans for a significant infrastructure project, the Ballarat Sewer Growth Project – Ballarat West UGZ Southern Section, valued at \$17.3 million. Scheduled for completion by 2028, this project aims to establish a reliable and sustainable sewer system, primarily benefiting the southern sections of the Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan area, which have been challenging to service.

The development of water infrastructure for the remaining areas of the Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan is currently manageable.

Similarly, sewer and water infrastructure required for the remaining areas of the Alfredton West Precinct Structure Plan is also manageable.

Required transport infrastructure for the Ballarat West and the Alfredton West are largely resolved by their respective precinct structure plans.

Figure 7: Existing zoned greenfield land (Source: Urban Development Program)



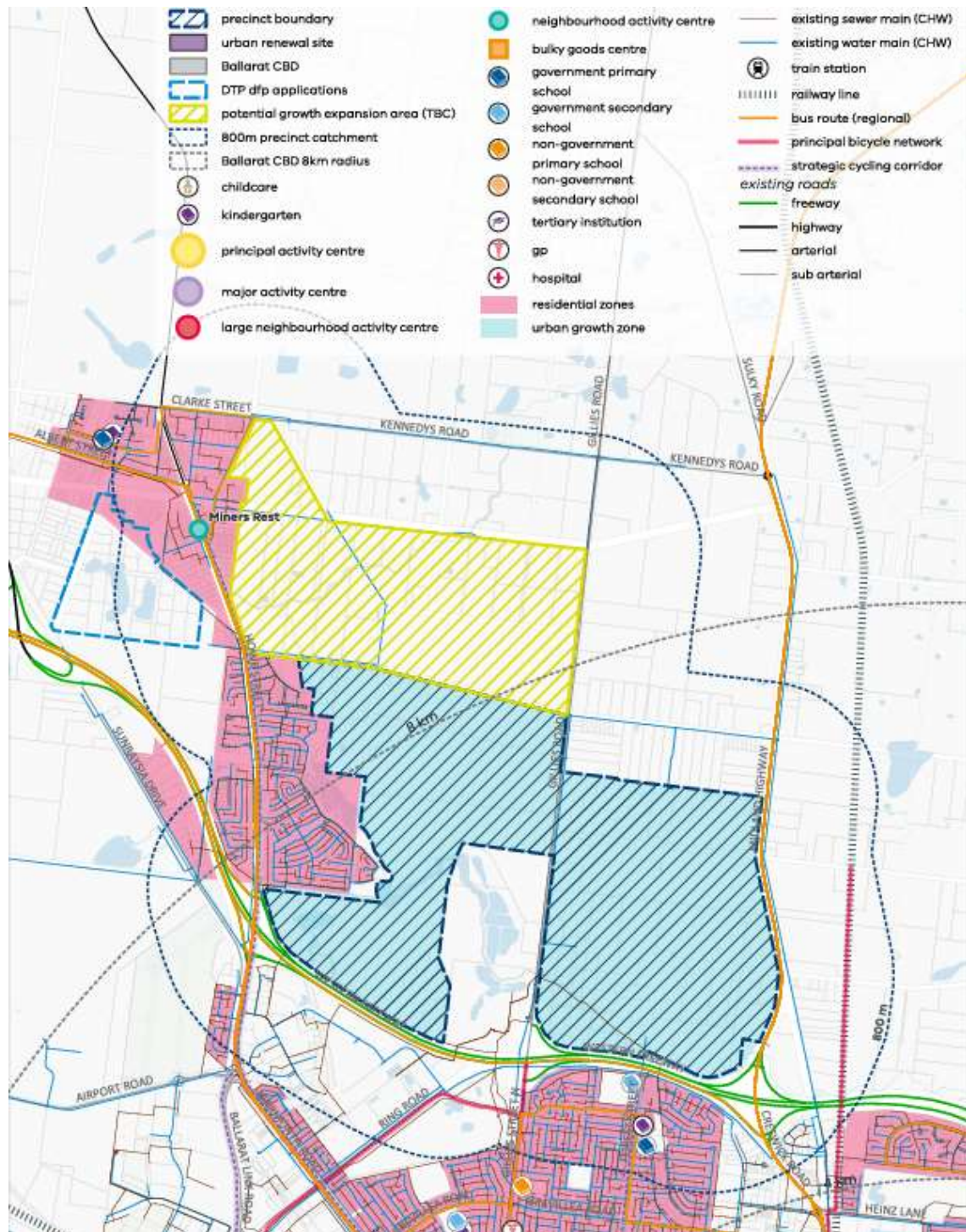
4.2 Future greenfield land

4.2.1 Zoned

Ballarat North precinct structure plan in progress (Core Area)

The Ballarat North Precinct Structure Plan (Core Area) could increase supply by approximately 5,600 dwellings or eight years. The precinct will help diversify the greenfield market by unlocking greenfield supply in the north.

Figure 8: Ballarat North Precinct Structure Plan



Sewer and water upgrades are approved to facilitate precinct growth.

Discussions with Central Highlands Water indicate that there will be sufficient sewer and water capacity to service the Ballarat North Precinct Structure Plan (core) area.

Two funded projects will facilitate growth in this area:

- A \$13 million pipeline project for water known as the Ballarat Water Growth Project – Northern growth area.
- A \$6.2 million pipeline project for sewer known as the Ballarat Sewer Growth Project – Northern growth area.

These projects are intended to be finalised between now and 2028. This coincides well with the progress of the Ballarat North Precinct Structure Plan which has an estimated approval date of mid-2026.

The precinct structure planning process has ensured that infrastructure is designed to accommodate the Expanded Area at the time it comes online.

Transport modelling undertaken as part of the Ballarat North PSP identifies upgrades of the Midland Highway, a state-owned road.

There are no other critical pre-planning thresholds that require resolution. The scale of potential State transport upgrades can be dealt with through the precinct planning process.

4.2.2 Unzoned

Ballarat North (Expanded Area)

Infrastructure issues and opportunities identified for the Ballarat North PSP (Core Area) also apply to the Expanded Area with a more significant challenge related to further upgrades required for the Midland Highway and potentially other State-owned roads.

Discussions with Central Highlands Water indicate that there will be sufficient sewer and water capacity to service the whole Ballarat North growth area.

Based on high level traffic modelling, State-owned roads will likely need to be upgraded if the Expanded Area is introduced.

Given that the Core Area (and other existing zoned greenfield land) provides Ballarat with an estimated 25 years of greenfield dwelling supply, there is limited policy rationale for opening additional greenfield land in the short to medium term. This is particularly crucial when considering that costs associated with State-owned roads may not be easily recovered, due to the absence of a clear funding mechanism.

Although there may not appear to be a policy rationale for developing the Expanded Area immediately, it is essential to carefully consider the timing of its development in relation to other greenfield areas. At a high level, the Expanded Area appears to have fewer constraints compared to other greenfield areas. Therefore, **the Expanded Area appears to be a good candidate for the next sequenced greenfield area to be prioritised for development when the need for additional greenfield land arises to meet the Plan for Victoria target.**

Table 7: Ballarat North (Expanded Area), sequencing dependencies, and pre-planning thresholds

Growth Area	North (Expanded Area)
Area	271 hectares
Approximate yield	2,600 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	Precinct Structure Plan
Sequencing dependencies	Development of the Ballarat North (Core Area)
Critical pre-planning threshold	Determine the ability to upgrade and fund any State Road upgrades required to service the Expanded Area.

North West Growth Area

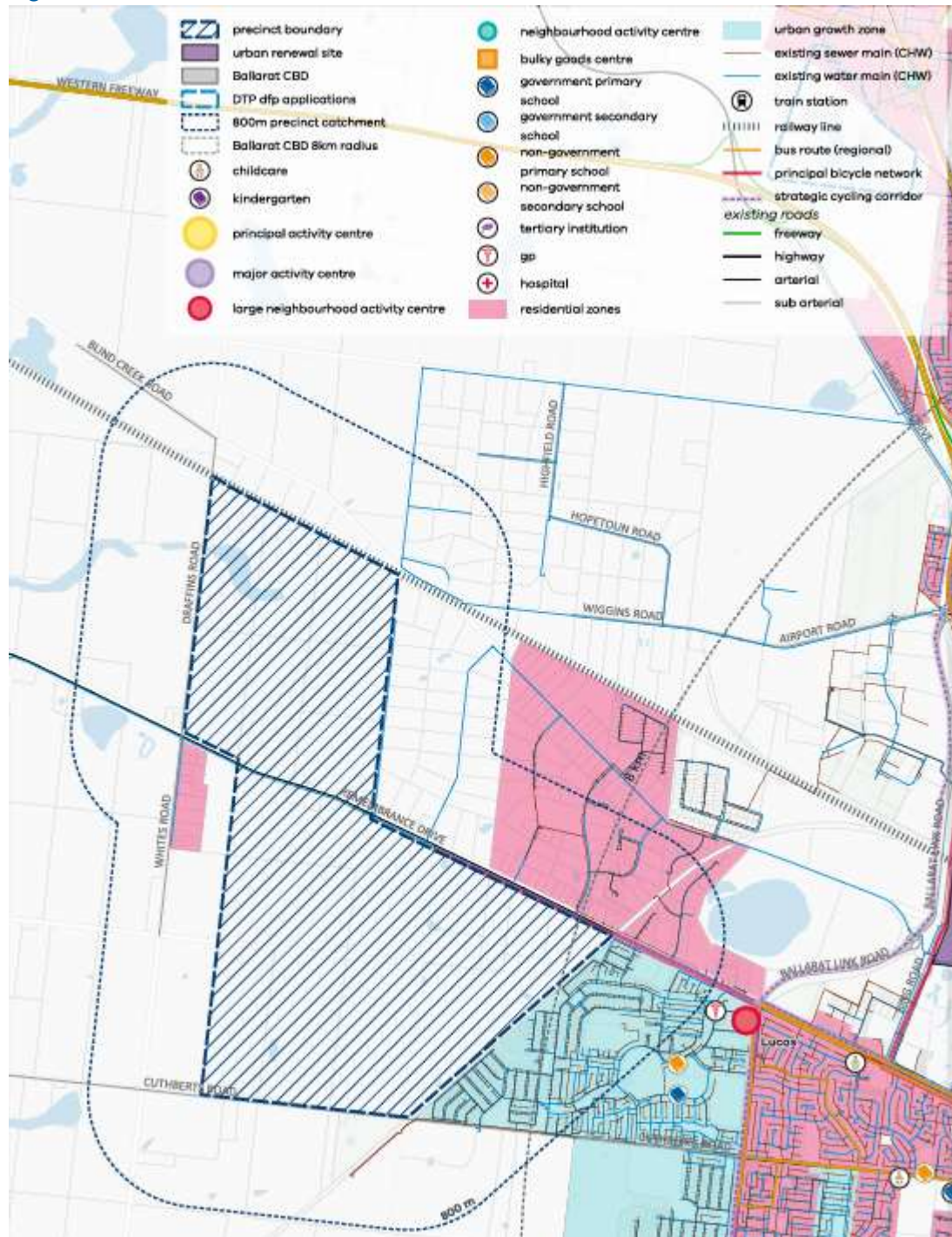
The Ballarat IGAF assumes that properties bounded by Remembrance Drive (i.e. Ballarat–Burrumbeet Road), the Skipton Ballarat Rail Trail and Finches Road form part of the North West Growth Area. Refer to the figure below.

Figure 9: Land bounded by Remembrance Drive (i.e. Ballarat–Burrumbeet Road), the Skipton Ballarat Rail Trail and Finches Road



While the City of Ballarat currently identifies that land as being included in the Western Growth Area (i.e. West of West), the IGAF report recommends its inclusion in the North West Growth Area as it contributes to the establishment of a contiguous development front.

Figure 10: North West Growth Area



Previous work undertaken by the City of Ballarat through its Long-term Growth Options Investigation (2018) ranked this precinct last for development.

According to the investigation, it did not reinforce the compact city form with almost none of the landholdings within an accessible 10 minute drive from the Ballarat CBD and relatively high infrastructure costs to service the area.

Even if viable, development was recommended as a long-term consideration once other proposed growth areas reach close to capacity.

Discussions with Central Highlands Water indicate that major upgrades to water and sewer infrastructure would be required to service the North West Growth Area. These infrastructure upgrades are currently unfunded.

At the time of writing, there is funding for other water and sewer works (not relating to the North West Growth Area) to be completed between 2023–2028. No further funding for other major projects will be approved until then.

Remembrance Drive (sometimes known as Ballarat–Burrumbeet Road) bisects the North West Growth Area and is of heritage significance.

Full development of the precinct is likely to require upgrading to at least four traffic lanes along the Remembrance Drive route, plus development of the Ballarat Link Road (to distribute cross town traffic) unless other alternatives are found to manage traffic. The heritage significance of Remembrance Drive poses a substantial challenge to road duplication efforts, requiring upgrades without compromising its historical value. The Ballarat Link Road is also currently unfunded.

The IGAF has focussed discussion onto Remembrance Drive due to its importance, although other roads and transport infrastructure may also need improvements.

The complete development of the North West Growth Area presents significant challenges with pre-planning requirements and threshold issues to resolve, refer to the table below.

Table 8: North West Growth Area, sequencing dependencies and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	North West Growth Area
Area	687 hectares
Approximate yield	8,560 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	Precinct Structure Plan
Sequencing dependencies	• Completion of the Growth Framework Plan. • The completion of stages 2 and 3 of the Ballarat Link Road (unfunded) should no other alternatives be found to distribute cross-town traffic. • The ability to fully service the area with water and sewer with the required ultimate infrastructure. • Demonstration that more greenfield supply is required prior to 2051 in line with Plan for Victoria housing targets.
Critical pre-planning threshold	• Determine the ability to upgrade and fund Remembrance Drive to a standard that could accommodate the whole growth of the North West without compromising heritage significance. • Determine the construction and funding timelines for stages 2 and 3 of the Ballarat Link Road.

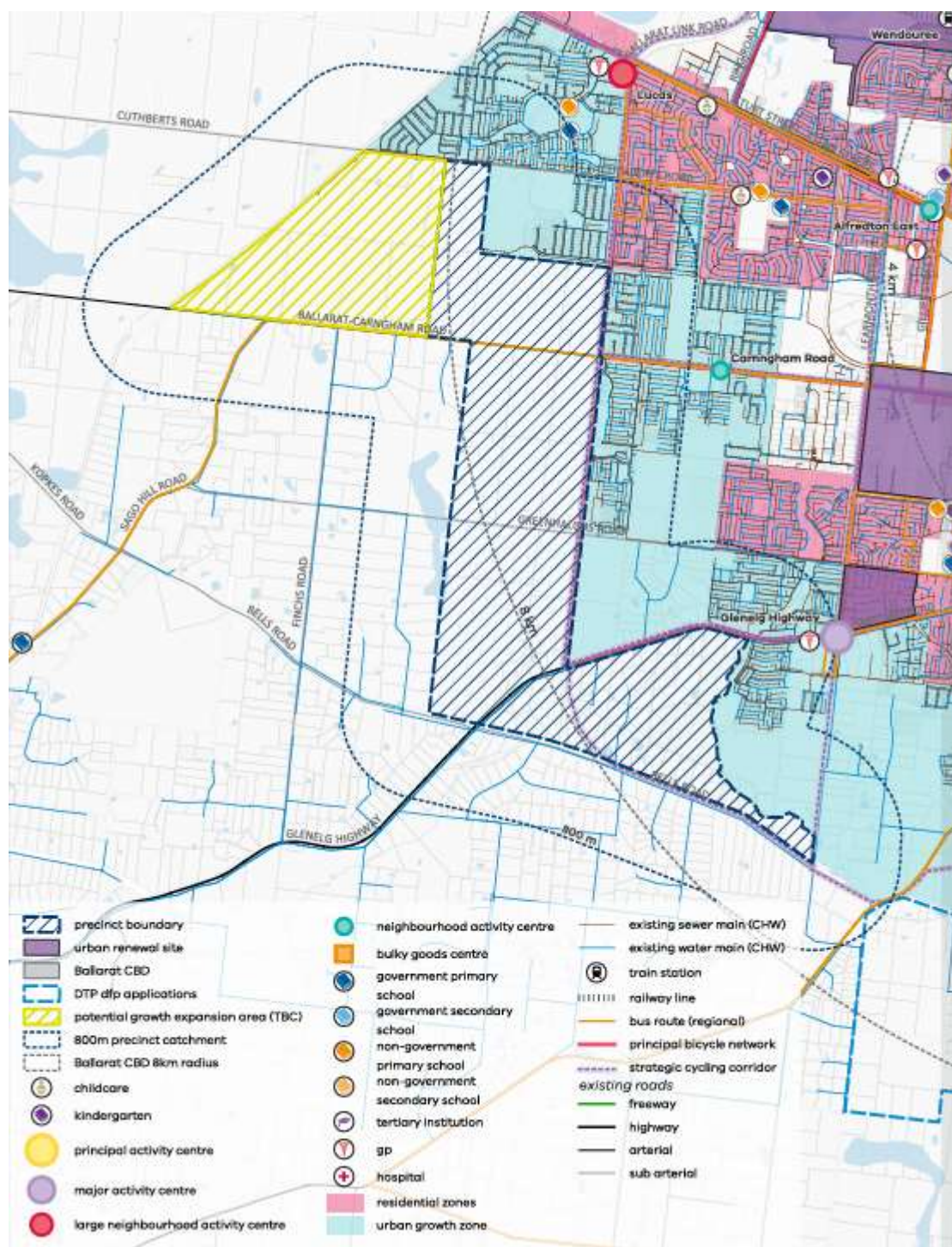
Even if all sequencing dependencies and pre-planning thresholds were addressed, the City of Ballarat still contains a significant amount of greenfield land. If the council and the State are

committed to the Plan for Victoria targets, caution should be exercised before unlocking more greenfield sites, particularly when the goal is to encourage a more compact urban form.

West of West Growth Area

The West of West Growth Area is contiguous to the existing Ballarat West PSP area.

Figure 11: Western Growth Area (i.e. West of West Growth Area)



The designated area, referred to as a *potential growth expansion area* in the West of the West Growth Area, was not assessed in the Long-term Growth Options Investigation (2018). However, following the public exhibition of the investigation paper, submissions were made requesting an

extension of the growth boundary. Following exhibition, on 23 February 2022, the City of Ballarat addressed these growth areas during a council meeting, stating, *"Officers considered these submissions and other inputs in determining the final northern and western growth area boundaries"* and that *"the area proposed is a logical extension of the Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan and is larger than the growth investigation area."*

Inclusion of the 'potential growth expansion area' must be subject to further consideration and the City of Ballarat has considered its 'potential growth expansion area' for the West of West as part of the Growth Area Framework Plan.

A major upgrade to water and sewer infrastructure would be required to service the West of West Growth Area.

In 2024, Central Highlands Water funding had only been identified for works to be completed between 2023–2028. The funding is for various projects but does not include projects that would directly service the West of West Growth Area. The infrastructure required is currently unfunded and will likely remain unfunded until at least the next pricing submission post-2028.

Completion of the Ballarat Link Road would likely be required to distribute cross-town traffic unless other alternatives are found to manage traffic. There is no current funding for the Ballarat Link Road project and therefore the cost of works would need to be acquired via other means. Without the Link Road, upgrades would likely be required on alternative north-south routes which would prove challenging.

While sewer and water are a challenge, the critical infrastructure required is the Ballarat Link Road. Without this road, the development is unlikely to be able to occur without other solutions to mitigate traffic.

Similar to the North West, the West of West Growth Area has some challenges with pre-planning requirements and threshold issues, refer to the table below:

Table 9: West of West Growth Area, sequencing dependencies and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	West of West Growth Area
Area	1,027 hectares
Approximate yield	12,440 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	Precinct structure plan
Sequencing dependencies	- Completion of the Growth Framework Plan. - The completion of stages 2 and 3 of the Ballarat Link Road should no other alternatives be found to distribute cross-town traffic. - The ability to fully service the area with water and sewer with the required ultimate infrastructure. - Demonstration that more greenfield supply is required prior to 2051 in line with Plan for Victoria housing targets.
Critical pre-planning threshold	Determine the construction and funding timelines for stages 2 and 3 of the Ballarat Link Road.

Similar to the North West Growth Area, even if all sequencing dependencies and pre-planning thresholds were addressed, the City of Ballarat still contains a significant amount of greenfield

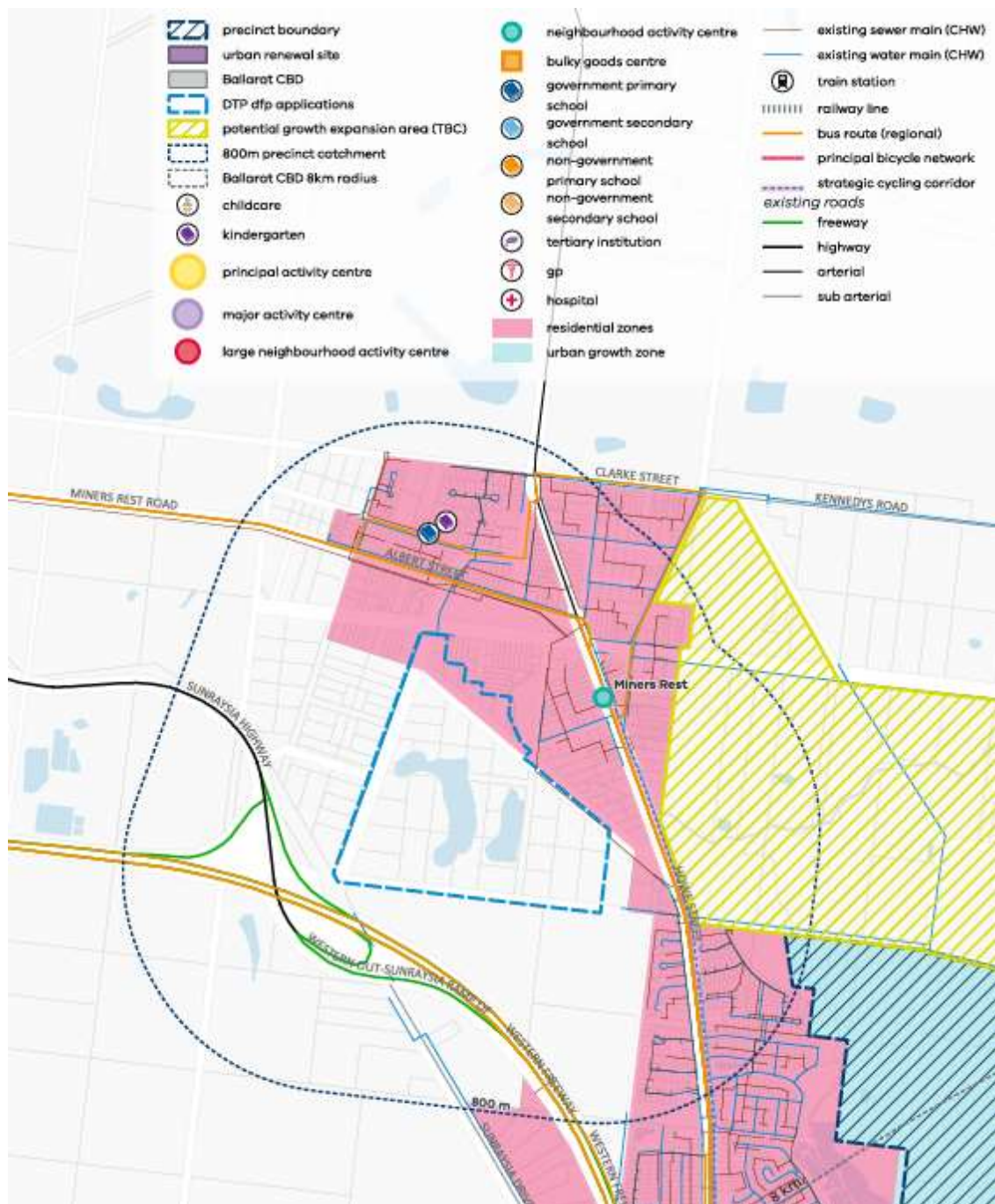
land. If the council and the State are committed to the Plan for Victoria targets, caution should be exercised before unlocking more greenfield sites.

4.3 Other greenfield land

Miners Rest (former quarry)

Based on the developer-led amendment previously considered by the Development Facilitation Program, this area could yield approximately an additional 400 dwellings.

Figure 12: Miners Rest (former quarry)



Sewer and water aligns with works that will occur in the in expanded area of the Northern Growth Area.

The VPA's high level assessment of the Miner's Rest (former quarry site) residential proposal suggests Sunraysia Highway, a rural two-lane road linking to the freeway, may require safety upgrades to accommodate significant levels of additional traffic. Additionally, Howe Street, a rural-standard two-lane road, may require safety and capacity upgrades as existing traffic volumes increase.

While these challenges could be overcome, there is limited strategic justification to prioritise short-term residential development investigations for this land, especially given the existence of multiple other known greenfield areas in addition to the existing greenfield.

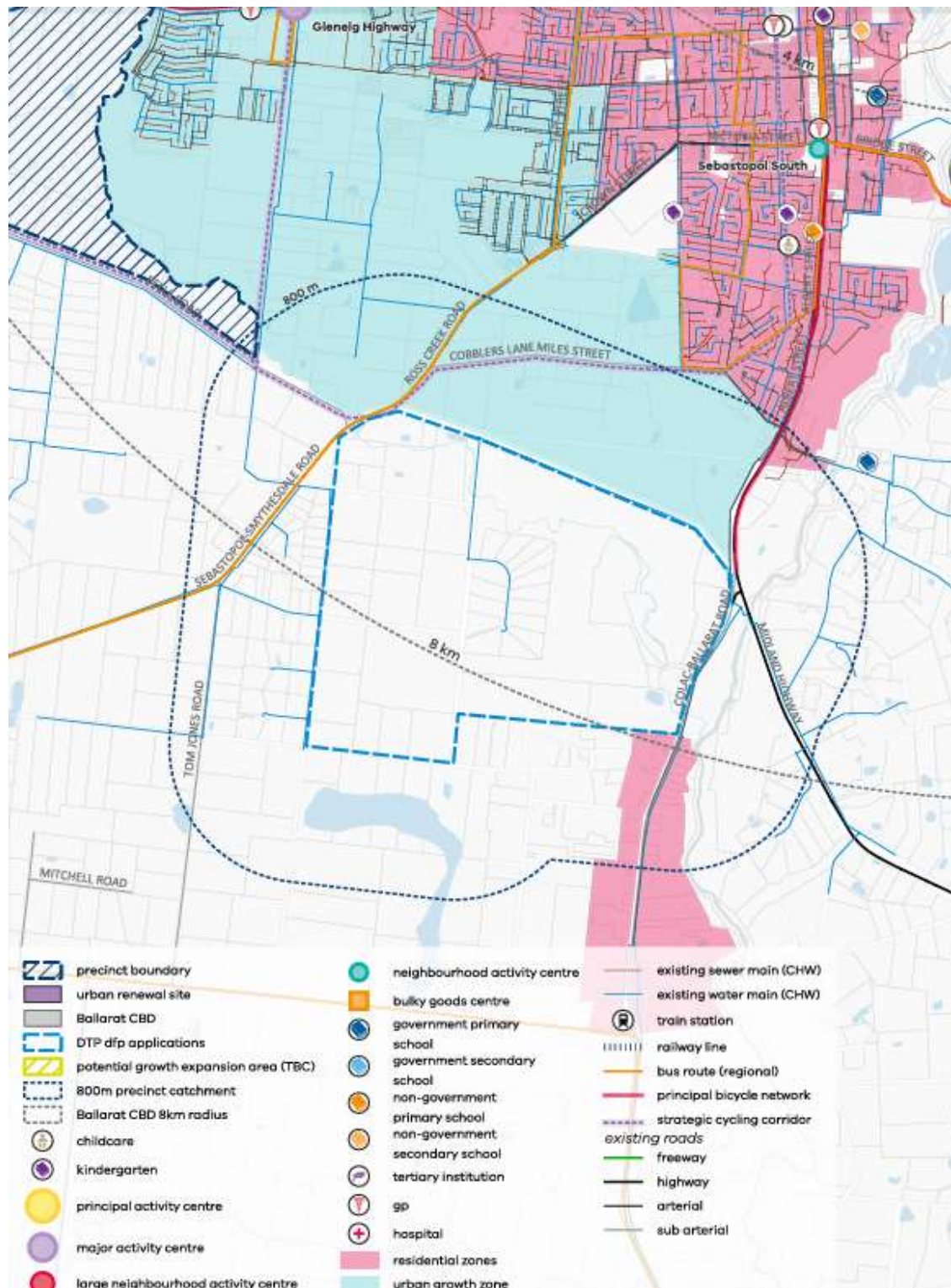
Table 10: Miners Rest (former quarry), sequencing dependencies, and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	Miners Rest (former quarry)
Area	61 hectares
Approximate yield	416 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	Planning Scheme Amendment to rezone land to a residential zone and subsequent planning permit
Sequencing dependencies	Development of the Expanded Area of the Ballarat North PSP.
Critical pre-planning threshold	Satisfactory rehabilitation of the quarry.

Cambrian Hill

Cambrian Hill could yield 3,000 dwellings. Although not part of the City of Ballarat, residents in this area primarily use Ballarat's services, making it a potential growth area that needs consideration against the municipalities greenfield land supply.

Figure 13: Cambrian Hill



Transport challenges faced by the West of West Growth Area are mirrored in Cambrian Hill.

Completing Link Road Stages 2 and 3 would facilitate cross-town traffic distribution. In the absence of the Link Road, upgrades may be required on alternate north-south routes (e.g. the Learmonth–Wiltshire–Cherry Flat Road route). At the time of writing, Stages 2 and 3 of the Link Road are unfunded.

If further assessment establishes alternatives to the Link Road, the subsequent challenge entails identifying a viable alternative north–south route.

The key question to address revolves around whether the delivery of the Ballarat link road in its entirety is critical to supporting build-out of Cambrian Hill. This requires further investigation. A secondary consideration then emerges being whether the existing and known road upgrades around the precinct are adequate to sustain a 3,000-lot precinct.

Regardless, Ballarat has significant amounts of unzoned but identified greenfield land, and careful consideration is essential before releasing additional greenfield sites, especially if aiming for balanced growth. Clearly, this presents a challenge as Cambrian Hill falls within a different municipality, limiting the City of Ballarat's control over the release of this land. It is essential, therefore, for the City of Ballarat to promptly engage in discussions with Golden Plains Shire, ensuring both councils align on the objective of a more compact urban form.

The availability of sewer and water may be able to be overcome as development in the existing Ballarat West PSP reaches completion in its southern boundary.

Table 11: Cambrian Hill, sequencing dependencies, and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	Cambrian Hill
Area	367 hectares
Approximate yield	3,000 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	Precinct structure plan
Sequencing dependencies	• The completion of stages 2 and 3 of the Ballarat Link Road should no other alternatives be found to distribute cross town traffic. • Build out of the existing Ballarat West Precinct Structure Plan. • The ability to fully service the area with water and sewer with the required ultimate infrastructure.
Critical pre-planning threshold	• Determine the construction and funding timelines for stages 2 and 3 of the Ballarat Link Road.

4.4 Infill land and urban renewal sites

4.4.1 Existing infill land

The City of Ballarat recognises significant unused potential in its existing infill areas.

The City of Ballarat's Housing Strategy 2023 identified a theoretical capacity to accommodate approximately 23,000 dwellings plus an additional 10,000–11,000 potential dwellings in infill areas. This achieves the Plan for Victoria non-greenfield target of 28,000 dwellings to 2051.

While existing residential zoned land holds significant untapped potential, market-driven elements could further impact the realistic development potential of that theoretical capacity. Testing the realistic market take-up of infill development requires further investigation and is outside the scope of the Ballarat IGAF.

Due to the uncertainty in predicting market uptake, development priorities, and the pace of housing construction, it is challenging to assess transport needs and evaluate the capacity of sewer and water systems.

Notwithstanding, a greater volume of housing should be developed on infill land to maximise the utility of existing infrastructure and services. It aligns with Plan for Victoria, and the City of Ballarat's Housing Strategy aspiration of a balanced growth approach between greenfield and established areas.

Besides planning related outcomes which will eventually see the recommendations of the Draft Housing Strategy 2023 implemented, there are a range of non-planning interventions that would be required to realise dwelling potential in infill areas such as:

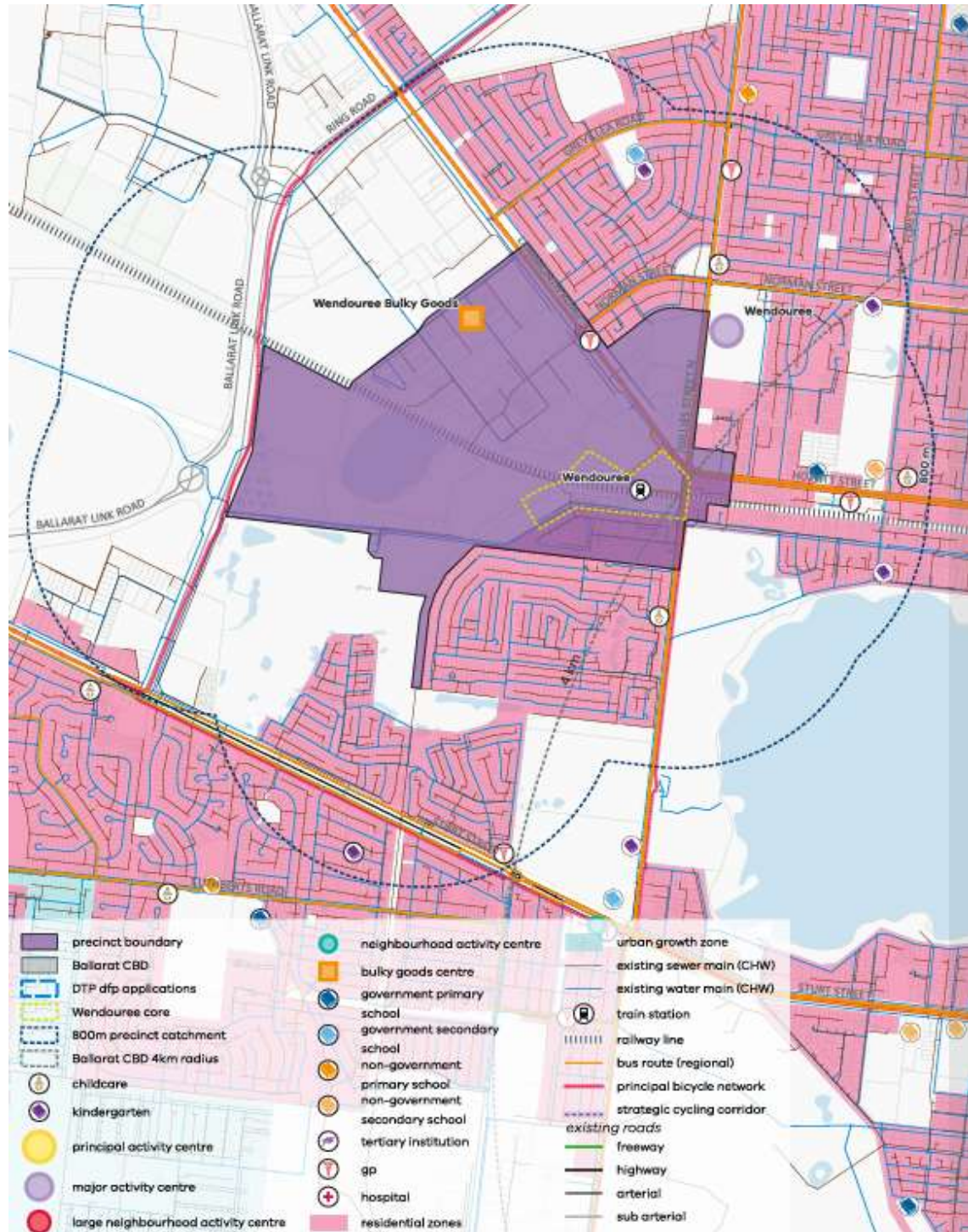
- Infrastructure and public services enhancements in identified Change Areas:
 - Upgrade infrastructure: Invest in updating and maintaining existing infrastructure like roads, utilities and active transit to support increased densities.
 - Enhance public services: Ensure adequate provision of essential services such as parks and maternal healthcare services in infill areas.
 - Improve connectivity: Enhance transportation links and walkability between infill development areas and the existing urban core.
- Community engagement and partnerships
 - Stakeholder collaboration: Work collaboratively with community members, developers, and other stakeholders to align visions and address concerns.
 - Public awareness campaigns: Educate the community about the benefits of infill development over sprawl.
 - Private-public partnerships: Engage in partnerships with private entities to facilitate and fund infill development projects.
- Market research and analysis

- Conduct feasibility studies: Analyse the economic viability and impacts of proposed infill developments to better hone into the realistic developability in the proposed infill areas especially in the Substantial Change areas.
- Identify market demand: Research and understand the market demands and preferences in potential Change Areas to further guide development.

4.4.2 Wendouree Village

Wendouree Village precinct is located north-west of the city centre, centred on Wendouree Train Station.

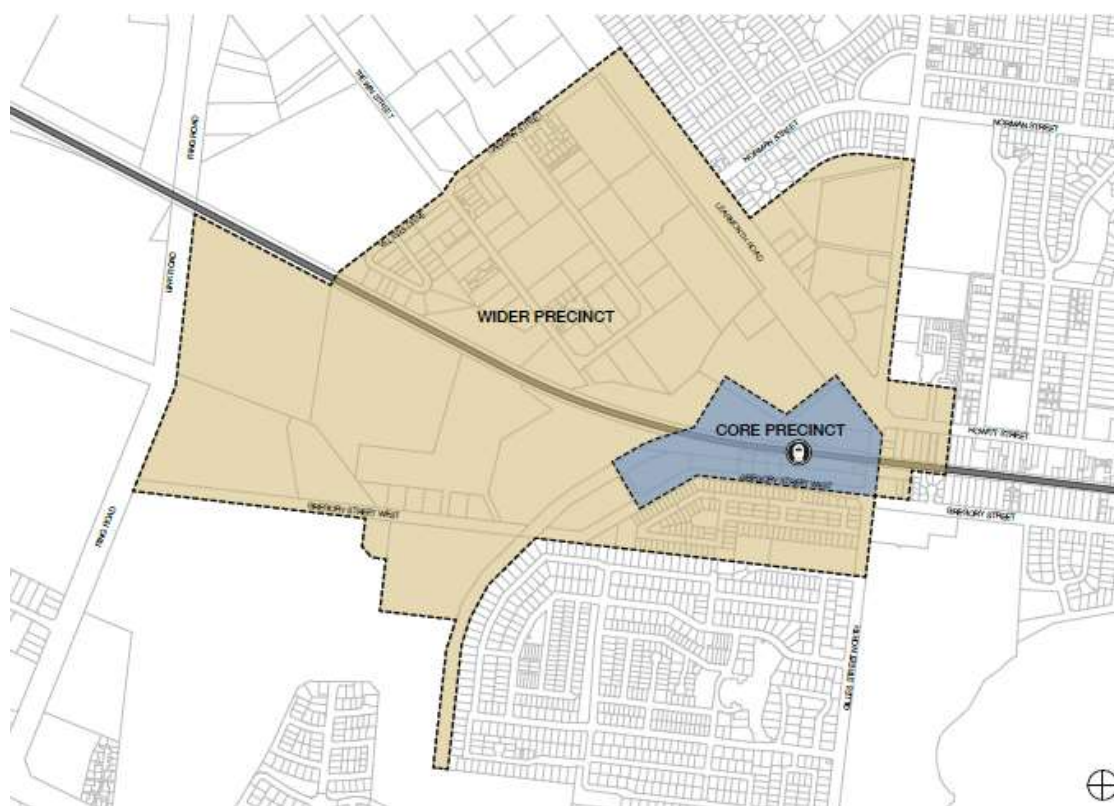
Figure 14: Wendouree Village



The *Wendouree Railway Station Precinct Master Plan 2019* prepared by SJB Urban for the City of Ballarat seeks to improve and enhance the mix of land use, walkability, and amenity in the precinct and proposes residential and mixed use around the train station core area. The master plan splits Wendouree Village into two distinct parts:

- A core precinct; and
- The wider precinct.

Figure 15: Wendouree Railway Station Precinct Master Plan 2019 overview (Source: SJB)



There is strong justification for this area to undergo urban renewal to deliver transit proximate residential development.

The capacity modelling undertaken by the VPA indicates the master plan core area could accommodate between 200–600 dwellings across 2–8 storey forms. This redevelopment would be immediately serviceable by existing infrastructure.

Over the long term there is the opportunity to explore further transition of industry out of the precinct and mixed-use development to deliver a transit-proximate development. The master plan identifies existing industrial land bounded by the rail line and Flax Mill Swamp reserve as potential for long term transition from industrial to residential. The land immediately north of the train station is a mix of government owned land, at grade railway parking and other uses that also has potential for transition to mixed use / higher density development in the long term. The two precincts would have capacity to accommodate an additional 4,000–11,000 dwellings (at 2–8 storeys). The current Ballarat West Employment Zone (BWEZ) buffer is a constraint that may limit sensitive uses in the west part.

Additional infrastructure funding would be required for redevelopment of the expansion area to deliver +1,000 dwellings requiring upgrades to the sewer and water network (major trunk assets), **and arterial road network**. This will require either funding from the State or via a

development contributions plan. Incremental development that increases residential density over the long term can be supported by infrastructure upgrades with appropriate sequencing plans in place.

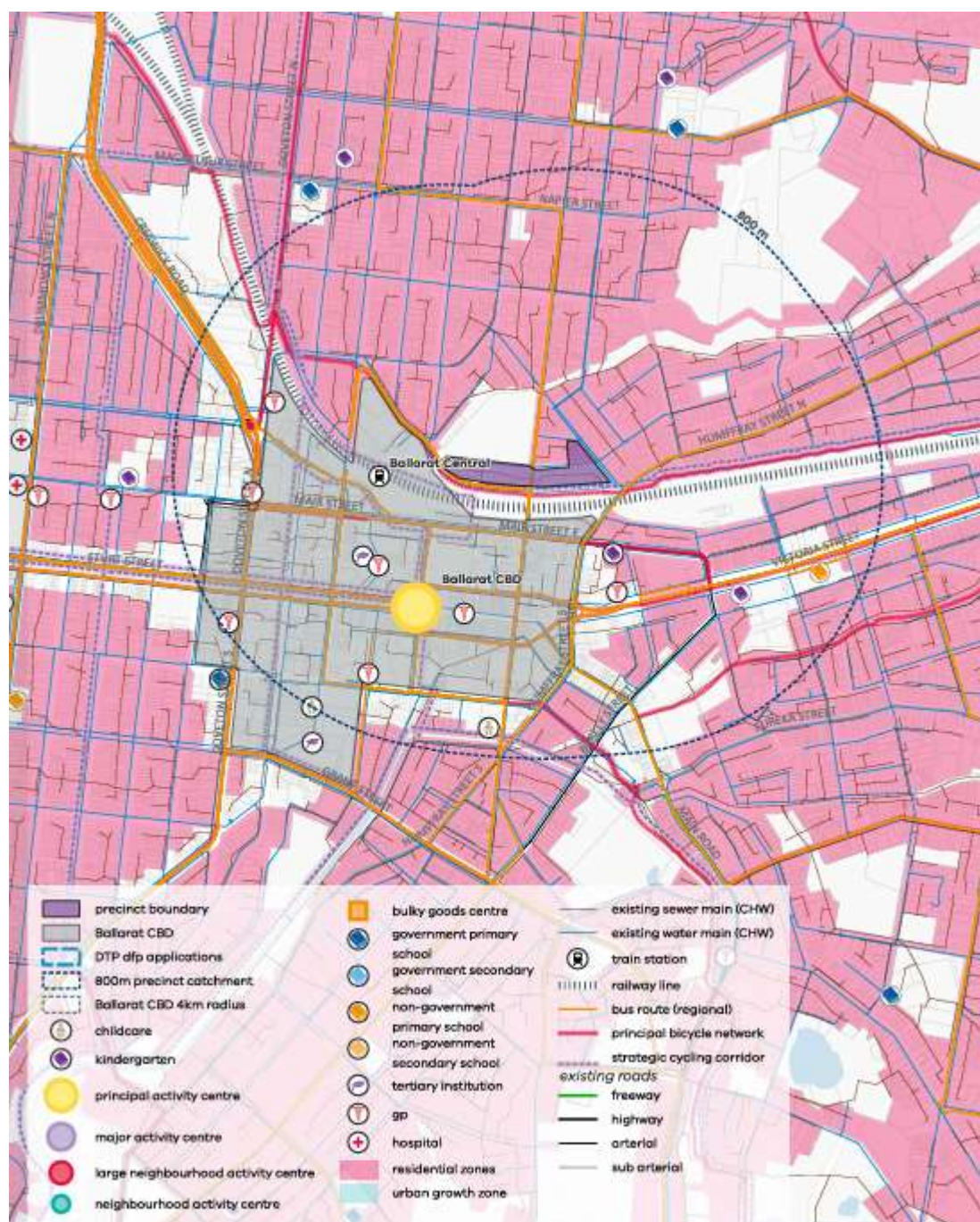
Table 12: Wendouree Village, sequencing dependencies, and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	Wendouree Village
Area	173 hectares
Approximate yield	Core Area: 200–600 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	- Core Area: Implementation of the master plan through proposed planning scheme amendment. Rezoning of industrial land to mixed use/residential and application of built form overlay(s). - Wider precinct: Preparation of a master plan and implementation as per Core Area.
Sequencing dependencies	- Core Area: Nil - Wider precinct: Funding commitments for infrastructure upgrades to service dwelling yield
Critical pre-planning threshold	- Wider precinct: Confirm that land is not necessary for commercial/industrial purposes through finalising the Employment Lands Strategy currently being progressed by the City of Ballarat. - Wider precinct: Determine the residential development threshold that triggers state infrastructure upgrades. Decide whether to plan up to that threshold or tightly control staging to align infrastructure upgrades with funding availability. - Core and Wider precinct: Confirm that area can be successfully rehabilitated. - Core and Wider Precinct: Industrial land use transition over the long term to be investigated through strategic assessment by the City of Ballarat.

4.4.3 Scott Parade

Scott Parade Precinct is located at the northern edge of Ballarat CBD just east of the Ballarat Train Station and within a walkable catchment to city centre services and facilities. The precinct is mainly zoned for commercial purposes (C1Z) with two small pockets of Public Parks and Recreation Zone (PPRZ) and Residential Growth Zone (RGZ1).

Figure 16: Scott Parade



It is a small urban renewal site relative to others with the capacity to deliver between 100 to 240 new dwellings across 2–8 storeys based on the capacity modelling undertaken by the VPA. Although higher yields could be contemplated subject to agreement with the City of Ballarat. The precinct presents an opportunity as a short-term urban renewal site given its relatively small size and nature of current industry and activity which is at a lesser scale than other precincts.

Redevelopment of the precinct of up to 240 dwellings can be readily serviced by existing infrastructure, with minor upgrades where required. Committed major sewer network upgrades can support increased yields. Specific transport impacts are consistent across the Selkirk, Creswick Road urban renewal precincts and to a lesser extent Scott Parade Precinct. A high proportion of daily traffic is expected to use Midland Highway, Norman Street and Howitt Street.

Redevelopment of Scott Parade as a standalone precinct is anticipated to have minimal impact with existing roads able to accommodate increased traffic volumes.

Table 13: Scott Parade sequencing dependencies and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	Scott Parade
Area	3 hectares
Approximate yield	100–240 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	Rezoning and built form overlays to support residential redevelopment
Sequencing dependencies	Nil
Critical pre-planning threshold	Confirm that land is not necessary for commercial/industrial purposes through finalising the Employment Lands Strategy currently being progressed by the City of Ballarat.

4.4.4 Creswick Road

Creswick Road precinct is located on the northern edge of the city centre, west of Ballarat Train Station. It is currently occupied by a range of light industrial, car-sales and other retail development that interface directly with established residential areas. The precinct contains several large parcels that provide redevelopment opportunities at scale with potential for residential development. Transition from industrial uses to large format retailing and high order retail/office uses may also be a consideration in conjunction with residential opportunity. Support for various opportunities require assessment of commercial and retail land uses, given the CBD's substantial size and the need to maintain its primacy. Potential land contamination issues may be present due to past industrial land use.

Figure 17: Creswick Road



Existing infrastructure can be upgraded to support redevelopment of Creswick Road precinct with minor capacity upgrades where relevant. **Sewer upgrades are needed but are not expected to be extensive and there is reasonable water pressure to service the area.**

Additional infrastructure funding may be required for the arterial road network. Specific transport impacts are consistent across the Selkirk, Creswick Road urban renewal precincts and to a lesser extent Scott Parade precinct.

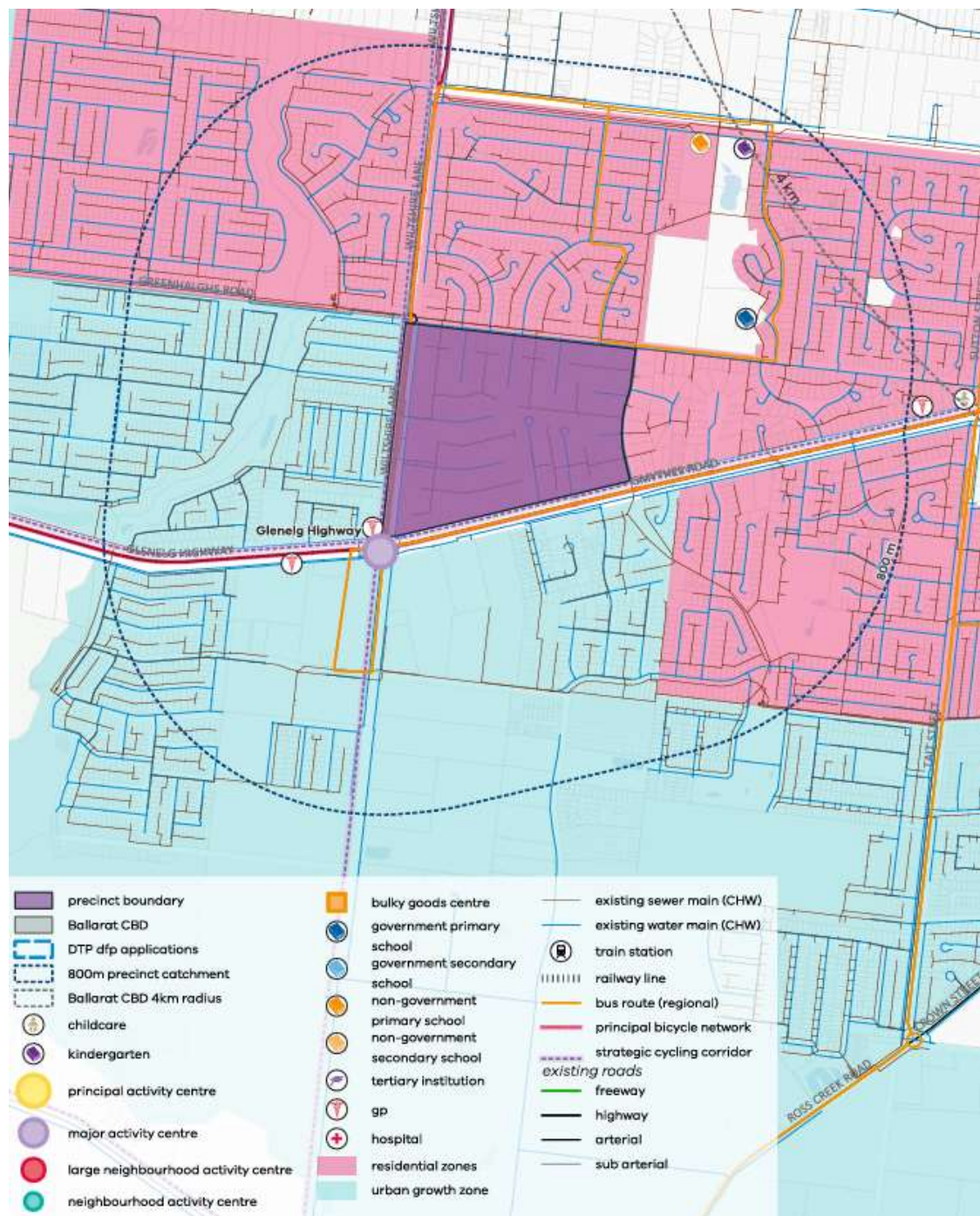
Table 14: Creswick Road sequencing dependencies and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	Creswick Road
Area	23 hectares
Approximate yield	1,600–4,700 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	Structure plan/masterplan process in combination with a rezoning and built form overlays to support redevelopment
Sequencing dependencies	Nil
Critical pre-planning threshold	• Confirm that land is not necessary for commercial/industrial purposes through finalising the Employment Lands Strategy currently being progressed by the City of Ballarat. • Confirm that any non-residential opportunities will not detract from the primacy of the CBD. • Determine the residential development threshold that triggers state infrastructure upgrades. Decide whether to plan up to that threshold or tightly control staging to align infrastructure upgrades with funding availability.

4.4.5 Delacombe

Delacombe Precinct is an established residential area with highly fragmented land ownership that limits this as a cohesive urban renewal precinct and is more akin to becoming a key change area targeted for residential infill development. The precinct is zoned General Residential Zone (GRZ1) and is not affected by overlays that would constrain increased residential density through infill redevelopment. Council's Housing Capacity Assessment identified potential infill capacity of approximately 1,000 dwellings within the GRZ1 land. There is evidence of infill redevelopment occurring to date with recent multi lot subdivisions on larger lots containing a single dwelling.

Figure 18: Delacombe Precinct



The Delacombe Precinct is adjacent to the Glenelg Highway Major Activity Centre. This activity centre is part of the approved precinct structure plan for Ballarat West growth area, with recent residential and commercial development occurring within and surrounding this activity centre.

Given the proximity of existing suburban housing to the new centre, there is opportunity for increased residential density in the area in response to this major retail and services hub. Higher densities can be achieved using the existing zone controls, however this could be further strengthened through amendments to the zone schedule to encourage higher density outcomes.

Infrastructure provision was not assessed for this precinct. Minor infrastructure upgrades should be able to support ongoing incremental redevelopment. This will require further assessment and costing.

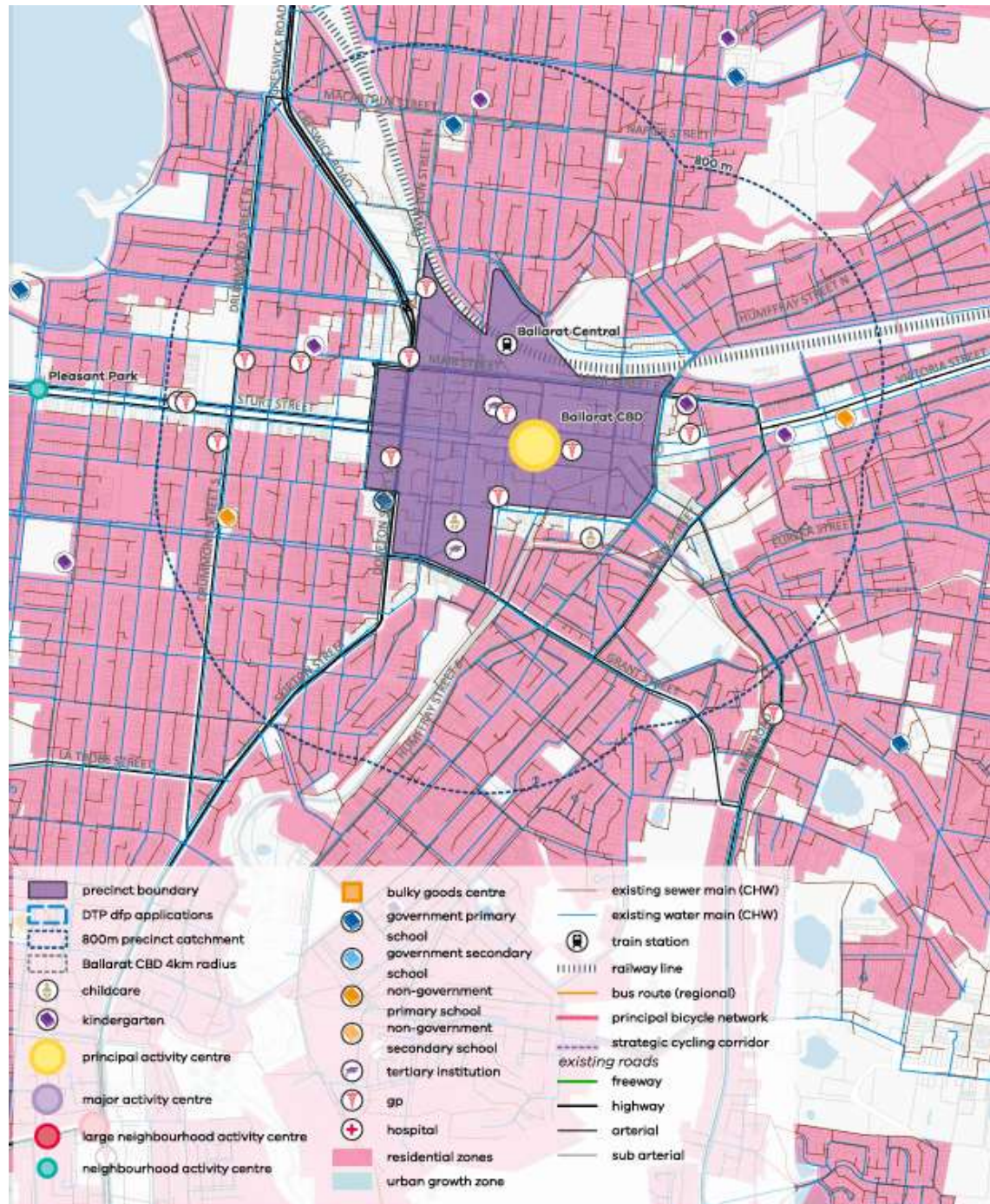
Table 15: Delacombe, sequencing dependencies, and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	Delacombe
Area	34 hectares
Approximate yield	Not assessed
Potential planning implementation tool	• Ongoing incremental infill is supported under zoning. • Completion of Council's Housing Strategy and Residential Zone and Overlay Reform projects to potentially establish precinct as a 'change area' for increased residential densities.
Sequencing dependencies	Nil
Critical pre-planning threshold	Not assessed.

4.4.6 Ballarat CBD

The Ballarat CBD is predominantly Commercial 1 Zone (C1Z) which allows for accommodation uses that complement the scale of the centre and maintain active/commercial ground floor frontages to retail streets. The Lydiard Street heritage precinct (HO171) affects the west part of the CBD and will inform overall built form outcomes for redevelopment sites in this part of the precinct.

Figure 19: Ballarat CBD



This precinct has significant potential to provide for new dwelling growth commensurate to its primacy as Ballarat's Major Activity Centre. Local area planning formally removed the Scott Parade precinct out of the CBD boundary as well as two other areas identified for high density residential to the east and south which are residential/mixed use zoning. Council's Housing Capacity Analysis 2022 identified potential for 4,000 dwellings that could be delivered in across C1Z land in the form of mixed use 4–6 storey developments.

The City of Ballarat's *CBD Strategy: Making Ballarat Central 2017–2021 (2017)* established an action plan to guide long term growth and change including increasing residents in the centre. Further work is currently underway by the City of Ballarat to understand the desired built form outcomes, including preparation of a CBD Structure Plan and Urban Design Framework.

Current planning controls are considered appropriate for allowing residential land use however it would be prudent for council to review built form controls and determine appropriate building scale, design, and public realm outcomes for the activity centre. The new suite of Activity Centre zones and overlays applied in the metropolitan Melbourne context may offer appropriate density and design standards and controls, including potential for developer contributions to infrastructure.

Additional state infrastructure funding, development contributions plan funding, would be required for redevelopment of the expansion area to deliver +4,000 dwellings requiring upgrades to the sewer and water network (major trunk assets) and school capacities.

Incremental development that increases residential density over the long term can be supported by infrastructure upgrades with appropriate sequencing in place. Large scale residential development in the short term may necessitate augmentation works to the sewer outfall trunk main associated with the Ballarat South Wastewater Treatment Plant will provide substantial additional capacity, noting that existing sewer network connecting to this trunk main would require upgrades to support major expansion of dwellings in the short term. There are no current plans for trunk water main upgrades, however it is understood that servicing to cater for increased residential densities is feasible based on topography of area.

Transport planning in the CBD should support the stated planning and urban design objectives for the precinct.

In accordance with Ballarat's Integrated Transport Action Plan, transport planning for the precinct should be focussed on putting people first and encouraging sustainable and diversified travel options. Movement networks should be designed with priority given to place considerations to make walking and cycling the preferred ways to move around the precinct.

To achieve these broader transport goals, residential development within the CBD should seek to provide the minimum car parking appropriate for the precinct.

Table 16: Ballarat CBD, sequencing dependencies, and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	Ballarat CBD
Area	78 hectares
Approximate yield	4,000 dwellings (based on the City of Ballarat's existing work)
Potential planning implementation tool	• Implementation of the CBD Structure Plan and Urban Design Framework through a Planning Scheme Amendment. • Application of built form overlay to manage building height, scale and streetscape outcomes in city centre. • Application of other controls where relevant (e.g. Parking Overlay) to manage other residential development outcomes
Sequencing dependencies	Nil
Critical pre-planning threshold	Finalisation of Council's CBD Structure Plan and Urban Design Framework and more detailed infrastructure analysis.

4.4.7 Selkirk Precinct (integrated with or independent of Eureka Stadium Sporting Precinct)

The Selkirk precinct is located north of Ballarat CBD and includes the Eureka Stadium precinct (including Mars Stadium) and Ballarat Showgrounds east of the train line and Creswick Road and a large industrial site occupied by Selkirk quarry and brick manufacturing. Land contamination issues may be present due to past industrial land use and end-of-life extractive industry rehabilitation is a critical consideration, particularly in relation to the extraction area.

Figure 20: Selkirk Precinct



Selkirk Bricks is a significant established business within the precinct, occupying the eastern half of industrial zoned land. There are currently no plans to relocate the manufacturing business

with Selkirk recently submitting an application to the City of Ballarat for an industrial subdivision that would involve compatible land uses which are not residential. Redevelopment of the Selkirk Bricks property into a business park could be feasible under the current zoning.

In the long-term, there is a potential sub-precinct opportunity for a 2–3 storey residential redevelopment in the Industrial 1 Zone (INZ1) land north of the Eureka Stadium complex fronting Norman Street. Capacity modelling for 2–3 storeys in this part of the precinct estimates that +800 dwellings could be delivered (i.e. low yield scenario 3 – without retail/commercial use). This would have lesser infrastructure demand than full precinct redevelopment.

Notwithstanding, **realising any residential uses within the major landholding held by Selkirk is extremely unlikely given the owners’ reluctance to pursue sensitive uses and their current application for an industrial subdivision.**

Additional State infrastructure funding, either from the State or via development contributions plans, would be needed for redevelopment of the full precinct including upgrades to the sewer and water network (major trunk assets), school capacities and arterial road network.

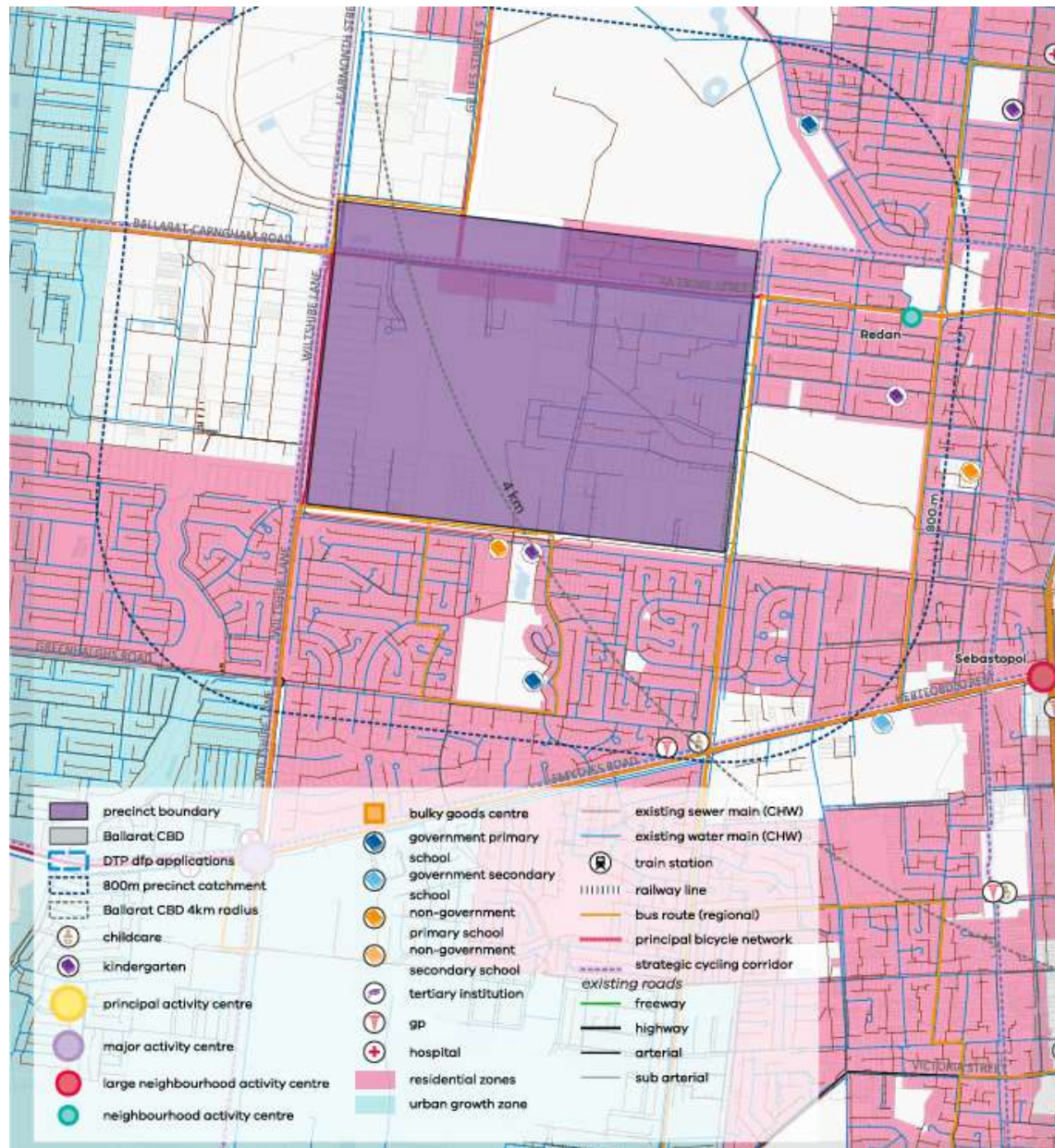
Table 17: Selkirk and Eureka Stadium Precinct, sequencing dependencies, and pre-planning thresholds

Growth Area	Selkirk and Eureka Stadium Precinct
Area	92 hectares
Approximate Yield	3,900–9,600 dwellings
Potential planning implementation tool	- Structure plan or master plan process for IN1Z land sub-precinct (following pre-planning assessment). - Application of precinct rezoning and built form overlays to support redevelopment
Sequencing dependencies	- Confirm that land is not necessary for commercial/industrial purposes through finalising the Employment Lands Strategy currently being progressed by the City of Ballarat. - Transition industry out of subject area and remediation of quarry land required. - Determine the residential development threshold that triggers state infrastructure upgrades. Decide whether to plan up to that threshold or tightly control staging to align infrastructure upgrades with funding availability.
Critical pre-planning threshold	Assessment of potential redevelopment of IN1Z land north of Eureka Stadium complex.

4.4.8 Ballarat Saleyards site and light industrial precinct (commercial/light industrial redevelopment)

The Ballarat Saleyards is a long-term renewal opportunity. The precinct presents some significant redevelopment opportunities, namely the large 12 hectare vacant Crown land holding due to the relocation of the saleyards operations. A large parcel in the centre of the site (affected by a Development Plan Overlay) and several other large parcels provide for redevelopment opportunities at scale.

Figure 21: Ballarat Saleyards Site



The bulk of this area is an existing and established industrial area save for the north-east corner of the precinct that is zoned Mixed Use Zone (MUZ) and General Residential Zone (GRZ). The land use appears to be predominantly warehousing and small-scale manufacturing with the GRZ portion of the area is used for housing.

Council is still actively approving industrial use and development applications within this area further cementing it as an industrial precinct. Over the long-term the precinct provides an urban renewal opportunity for mixed use outcomes based on relocation of any existing noxious industry. This precinct may provide an opportunity for a smaller extent of residential land use, with more emphasis on light industrial, commercial and mixed-use outcomes.

Table 18: Ballarat Saleyards site and light industrial precinct (commercial/light industrial redevelopment) sequencing dependencies and pre-planning thresholds

Growth area	Ballarat Saleyards
Area	152 hectares
Approximate yield	Not assessed
Potential planning implementation tool	• Structure plan or master plan process • Application of precinct rezoning and built form overlays to support redevelopment.
Sequencing dependencies	• Transition industry out of subject area and remediation of land required. • Confirm that land is not necessary for commercial/industrial purposes through finalising the Employment Lands Strategy currently being progressed by the City of Ballarat.
Critical pre-planning threshold	Assessment of potential redevelopment of IN1Z land north of Eureka Stadium complex.

5 STAGING AND SEQUENCING RECOMMENDATIONS

The Ballarat IGAF sets out a series of planning priorities across the short (to 2028), medium (2029–2033) and long term (2034 onwards) based on the information collected in the body of the report. Recommendations of the Ballarat IGAF include:

5.1 General recommendations

General

- 1 The City of Ballarat to implement a comprehensive and assertive program to plan, zone and incentivise development of additional housing in targeted areas of Ballarat's existing built-up area.
- 2 Council to deliver structure planning and rezoning for designated established urban areas within the municipality.
- 3 The City of Ballarat to report on residential land supply every two years. The report should focus on evaluating the progress in achieving Plan for Victoria housing targets for established (infill and urban renewal) and greenfield areas. The findings should focus on:
 - a. Sequencing and short, medium, and long-term recommendations of the IGAF remain adequate or need adjustment to meet current market needs, avoid price escalation, and/or respond to any shift in direction of State or local policy;
 - b. Identify any market constraints that have occurred in the interim two year period that may impact development viability; and
 - c. Identification of mechanisms and levers that council can use to facilitate development and address barriers to development such as fragmentation of ownership of land, including but not limited to rates, capital works investment, lot consolidation, and working with service agencies to sequence essential sewer and water upgrades in advance of development.
- 4 The City of Ballarat in consultation with DTP should develop a funding and delivery strategy for State transport infrastructure upgrades to 2051 to support achieving the *Plan for Victoria* growth targets (e.g. the Ballarat Link Road).
- 5 Planning for both urban renewal and greenfield growth precincts must include application of a development contributions plan/s that capture and levy development contribution for key State infrastructure (as well as local infrastructure).

5.2 Short term recommendations (to 2028)

5.2.1 Infill and urban renewal areas

- 6 Implement a Ballarat Settlement Boundary as per Plan for Victoria – Action 3 Carefully manage the outward sprawl of regional cities and towns.
- 7 City of Ballarat to commence its Urban Renewal Area Program to prepare structure plans for the Ballarat CBD Precinct, LaTrobe Saleyards Precinct and Wendouree Station Precinct.
- 8 To facilitate residential development in established areas of Ballarat, DTP will work with the City of Ballarat to finalise the following draft strategies to align with Plan for Victoria actions and progress relevant planning scheme amendments to the Ballarat Planning Scheme as follows:

- a. Implement the Ballarat Housing Strategy via an amendment.
 - b. Implement the Ballarat Growth Areas Framework Plan. This must not result in an amendment for immediate rezoning of new greenfield land which should occur in line with the Plan for Victoria housing targets.
 - c. Prepare an amendment to rezone Scott Parade to facilitate higher density residential development.
 - d. Finalise and prepare an amendment to implement the draft Employment Lands Strategy. This should include confirmation that industrial land in the rest of the known urban renewal areas is not necessary for commercial/industrial purposes and identify where buffers can be reduced to sensitive uses. Undertaking this work will also confirm the residential opportunity at Ballarat Saleyards, as well as expanded residential opportunities at Wendouree, ahead of future spatial planning for these sites.
- 9 Investigate the residential threshold capacity for both the wider Wendouree Village, Creswick Road area and Ballarat Saleyard. This analysis should determine the maximum number of dwellings that can be developed in these areas before reaching infrastructure capacity in addition to any contamination challenges that will need to be resolved prior to introducing sensitive uses.
- 10 The City of Ballarat must initiate non-planning interventions to facilitate further infill (refer to Section 4.4.1)

5.2.2 Greenfield areas

- 11 The City of Ballarat must facilitate development in the existing Ballarat West PSP to maximise development in existing gazetted PSPs with infrastructure capacity.
- 12 VPA (DTP) should complete the Ballarat North PSP (Core Area) and implement via a planning scheme amendment to the Ballarat Planning Scheme.
- 13 The City of Ballarat must not progress additional rezoning of greenfield land in the Ballarat North (Expanded Area), North West, West of West, and Miners Rest in the short term.
- 14 The proposed rezoning at Cambrian Hill is not required in the short term. Golden Plains Shire Council addresses longer term strategic planning for Cambrian Hill in its *Growing Places Strategy – a Plan for Growth to 2051*.

5.3 Medium term recommendations (2029–2033)

5.3.1 Infill and urban renewal areas

- 15 To progress urban renewal development, the City of Ballarat should extend its Urban Renewal Area Program to include:
- a. Continue to incentivise development in targeted urban renewal areas of established Ballarat.
 - b. Finalise strategic planning on the wider Wendouree Village and Creswick Road area.
 - c. Prepare and finalise structure plan for the Creswick Road precinct, based on the capacity of any confirmed infrastructure upgrades.
 - d. If sensitive uses can be pursued in the Ballarat Saleyard site, prepare structure plan (or similar).

5.3.2 Greenfield areas

- 16 The City of Ballarat is to continue to facilitate development in the existing Ballarat West PSP and the Ballarat North PSP (Core Area).
- 17 The City of Ballarat should commence strategic planning for greenfield sites only if required as per the findings of the bi-annual review and in consultation with the State Government.

5.4 Long term recommendations (2034 onwards)

- 18 Complete rezoning of all other potential renewal areas.
- 19 As per the findings of the biannual report prepared by the City of Ballarat, undertake the following in the longer term:
 - a. Monitor ongoing use of the Selkirk site and surrounds to determine capacity to realise mixed use urban renewal outcomes.
 - b. Continue facilitating development in existing PSP, infill and urban renewal areas.
 - c. Commence structure planning for other greenfield areas only if required.

5.5 Sequencing recommendations

The recommended growth sequence aims to maximise the use of existing infrastructure, guide resourcing for future strategic work and should be read in conjunction with the short, medium, and long-term timeframes.

Urban renewal (can occur concurrently):

- Ballarat CBD
- Wendouree Village Core Precinct
- Scott Parade
- Wendouree Village Wider Precinct
- Creswick Road
- Ballarat Saleyard
- Selkirk.

Greenfields (sequenced):

- Ballarat North PSP (Expanded Area)
- West of West Growth Area/Miners Rest Quarry Hill
- North West Growth Area/Cambrian Hill

The recommended sequencing is subject to certain conditions and caveats:

- While the urban renewal projects are outlined in a specific sequence, this order is not mandatory. The priority is to advance urban renewal projects as soon as possible to achieve the Plan for Victoria housing targets and growth split. Should adequate funding and resources become available, any of these projects can be expedited and initiated at the earliest opportunity.
- Ballarat Saleyards is lower on the priority list due to the extensive work required to confirm its suitability for sensitive uses, transition from noxious uses, and rehabilitate the site. However, if these tasks can be completed sooner, the site should be prioritised.

- Selkirk is currently sequenced last (under urban renewal) because it is understood that the landowner is not prepared to develop the site for mixed use with a residential component. However, given its ideal location for urban renewal, it should be moved up in priority if development becomes feasible earlier.
- Ballarat North Precinct Structure Plan (Core Area) is not sequenced as it is active.
- Infill area development is not sequenced as it is actively ongoing and will be further facilitated by the City of Ballarat's work through its Draft Housing Strategy. It is assumed that infill development will continue from the present into the long-term and should be a priority.
- Sequencing Cambrian Hill poses a challenge as it lies within a different municipality. It is advisable that development here is deferred to the medium- to long-term. With ample future greenfield land available within the City of Ballarat, prioritising a new growth area outside the municipal boundary which would benefit solely on existing and future infrastructure in the City of Ballarat without providing benefits such as council rates, is not urgent.
- Cambrian Hill is not sequenced as it lies outside Ballarat's municipal limits.
- Scott Parade is marked as third and Wendouree Village Core Area as second in sequence. However, either could start at any time, subject to available funds and resources. Wendouree Village was prioritised due to its existing structure plan and the assumption that it would be practically easier to implement an existing piece of work.
- Wendouree Village Wider Precinct and Creswick Road are placed fourth and fifth, respectively. Their sequence is flexible, with the Wendouree Village Wider Precinct considered potentially easier as it would follow the work undertaken for the Wendouree Village Core Area.
- The sequencing of the North West and West of West Growth Areas depends heavily on the recommendations of the Growth Framework Plan, and Plan for Victoria housing targets. The Ballarat IGAF suggests development of the Ballarat Link Road may be required, but further studies may also show that traffic can be managed with other external upgrades instead. If the Ballarat Link Road is necessary, it should be planned to align with the future PSP sequencing. Although the Ballarat IGAF offers initial sequencing, the Growth Framework Plan will clarify the timing and extent of development, whether it is for the entire growth area or in smaller, sequential sections in multiple precinct structure plans.
- The development of the former Ballarat Saleyards, while relatively late, depends on Development Victoria's decisions regarding the site, along with the transition of potentially noxious uses, land rehabilitation, and the feasibility of introducing sensitive uses to these areas. Given the potential time required for these processes, initiating work promptly is advisable, although actual development may commence later.
- This plan depends on a review of dwelling supply and the available precincts ready for development in line with the direction of Plan for Victoria through housing targets and the 60/40 growth split. The review should be undertaken by the City of Ballarat at least once every two years and would not be a wholesale review of the Ballarat IGAF. This review would focus on evaluating the progress in achieving targeted infill numbers, the remaining land in greenfield areas, and the advancement of urban renewal work. Based on these findings, the City of Ballarat can determine if the sequencing and short, medium, and long-term recommendations of the IGAF remain suitable or need adjustment to meet current market needs which can be dealt with at a municipal level.

6 ALTERNATIVE PATHWAYS

In cases where proponents seek large scale development outside the suggested sequence of growth, consideration should be given to developments supporting the City of Ballarat's identity as a compact, highly liveable, and well-connected city—an initiative integral to *The Ballarat Strategy 2040*¹⁰ or any other document which supersedes it.

While the Ballarat IGAF does not intend to limit supply, *Plan for Victoria* establishes a clear 46,900 housing target for Ballarat of which 28,000 dwellings or 60 per cent should be developed in non-greenfield areas, and 18,900 dwellings should be developed in greenfield areas. A balance must be struck between housing delivery; good and orderly planning; as well as the relative cost of servicing growth¹¹. The latter being important as the relative cost of delivering infrastructure in greenfield settings can be between two to four times more expensive than leveraging of established areas that can accommodate additional growth.

To determine the suitability of a significant proponent led development outside the recommended growth sequence, the following criteria¹² have been prepared in consultation with the City of Ballarat and DTP. Any out-of-sequence proposals should meet all criteria:

- A. The proposal is of a size and scale to be considered a significant growth front for Ballarat's future. The significance of the growth front is to be determined to the satisfaction of the planning authority.
- B. The proposal meets the principle of the '10 Minute City' which provides strategic direction that future development can and should be focused within roughly an 8km arc from the centre of Ballarat, to support the future of Ballarat as a compact, highly liveability and connected city.
- C. The developer or consortium represents the vast majority of the developable land area in that precinct (e.g. at least 70 per cent unless otherwise agreed by the planning authority).
- D. The proponent agrees to fund all necessary feasibility assessments to the satisfaction of the planning authority.
- E. The proponent agrees to a precinct structure plan or similar for the entirety of the precinct, inclusive of areas beyond its ownership to the satisfaction of the planning authority.
- F. The proposal is connected to the existing urban area – disconnected or 'leapfrog' development will be discouraged.
- G. The location minimises overall civil, community and transport infrastructure costs.
- H. The location minimises impacts on Ballarat's historic urban landscape, the environment and Ballarat's natural resource base to the satisfaction of the planning authority.

¹⁰ Initiative 3.7 of the Ballarat Strategy

¹¹ Infrastructure Victoria recognises that "the total cost of infrastructure supporting housing, excluding transport, typically ranges from being two to four times more expensive in greenfield areas than established areas". While the scope of the report is centred on Metropolitan Melbourne, it is important to note that there is no evidence to preclude the extrapolation of these findings to a regional context.

¹² Several criteria on this list have been reworked from Initiative 3.7 of the Ballarat Strategy 2040.

- I. The proposal must provide an integrated transport strategy to the satisfaction of DTP including an implementation plan showing how the proposal would contribute towards the delivery of alternative transport modes that reduces motor vehicle use to the satisfaction of the planning authority.
- J. The proposal must demonstrate provision for social and affordable housing (as defined in the *Planning and Environment Act 1987*) as agreed with the planning authority.
- K. If the proposed development represents a smaller portion of a larger precinct, the proposal must provide an infrastructure contributions assessment that considers impacts on, and demand for, infrastructure beyond the site boundary at the Precinct scale.
 - a. The infrastructure contributions assessment may need to make provisions for a “top-up” cash contribution for infrastructure external to the site to minimise any funding gap in a future precinct scale contributions plan.
- L. If the proposed development requires upgrades and augmentation of infrastructure outside its boundaries, the proponent must demonstrate that its development will not create additional cost to council or State Government or can demonstrate that the relevant authorities are ready to fund 100 per cent of the augmentation.
- M. The proponent must clearly demonstrate that there is a short-term need for additional land supply in accordance with the Plan for Victoria growth targets.
- N. The proposed land must be within a growth area that is defined in the Ballarat Planning Scheme or a council-adopted framework such as the *Growth Area Framework Plan* currently under preparation.
- O. The proponent must demonstrate consistency with relevant targets in the VPA PSP 2.0 Guidelines or as otherwise agreed to with the planning authority.

Proponents must provide a response to these criteria to the satisfaction of the City of Ballarat and the Department of Transport and Planning.

7 CONCLUSION

The successful management of Ballarat's expected increase of 46,900 dwellings by 2051 requires a pivotal shift towards prioritising non-greenfield development to achieve a compact city model.

This approach aligns with Infrastructure Victoria's recommendations and ensures numerous benefits. These include substantial infrastructure cost savings, conservation of land for agriculture and wildlife, reduced urban sprawl, less traffic congestion, and a higher use of public transport leading to positive environmental and health outcomes. It creates better opportunities for businesses and potentially enriches the Victorian economy.

The Ballarat IGAF provides a high-level plan to achieve this transformation. It advocates for a balance between urban renewal and controlled greenfield development. The IGAF recommendations include a focus on urban renewal in the short-term, strategic planning for ongoing development supply in the medium term, and continued monitoring and development of new potential urban renewal areas in the long-term.